iTao

Foreword..... 1
iTao.....1
The Involution.....9
The Evolution.....15
The Path..... 33
The Science and Reality.....50

Foreword

In ancient times, human beings possessed a dull, instinctive perception of what was called the Tao. Ancient sages perceived Tao as All, as the goal and the path to that goal. Instead of direct perception, modern man employs concepts regarding the Tao that allow to make three assertions. These can be considered as the axioms of the spiritual science or the science of Tao. Just as the science of geometry is built upon Euclid’s axioms, so too can a science of Tao be constructed upon these assertions.

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iTao

Tao that can be told is not the eternal Tao.

(Tao Te Ching 道德經 1)

"iTao" is an abbreviation of the expression "I am Tao". Since "Tao is All" it can only be defined in terms of itself. Therefore, Tao also signifies "I am the 'I Am'". As there cannot be two "All", the Tao is referred to as the "One without the Other". Tao must possess consciousness; otherwise, man - as a part of All - likewise lack consciousness. Names such as God, Brahma, Allah, absolute Spirit and the Absolute are also designations for Tao. Tao cannot be defined, for All is infinite and encompasses all concepts inside itself. One can only assert that Tao is conscious and infinite. In other words, this means that the absolute, infinite God is self-conscious, and that whatever a human being is - or is not - capable of realizing exists inside the consciousness of God, who is All.

One must distinguish the concepts of infinity from the conscious Infinity itself, which is All and encompasses all concepts. For example, the concept of the infinity of natural numbers is based on the assumption that the number 1 can be added to any natural number N. Yet this is not a definition of Infinity, but merely a finite concept presupposing the existence of any number N - an assumption that is incorrect. Something finite cannot define the Infinite, which is All.

Tao is the one, infinite, conscious source of everything that a human being is capable or incapable to perceive. Tao is also the one, absolute, infinite, conscious reality that is All. Therefore, the following assertion can be made.

Tao is self-conscious.

Since Tao exists and is self-conscious, it always exists and is self-conscious. There can be no state in which Tao is not self-conscious; otherwise, it would not be All. Only that which is All can possess infinite consciousness or be infinite; therefore, consciousness of Tao is infinite. A finite consciousness

of Tao would imply the existence of something outside its consciousness. However since Tao is All, everything that can exist must also be inside consciousness of Tao.

Consciousness and existence are inseparable. Since the consciousness of Tao is infinite, there can be neither beginning nor end to the possibilities of manifestation inside the consciousness of Tao. To be manifested - or to be a being - always means to be inside the consciousness of Tao and to have finite consciousness. The finite consciousness is to be understood in the sense that it does not encompass All. Everything that is manifested will henceforth be referred to as the *manifested world structure*, or simply the *world structure*.

The concept of consciousness cannot be defined, because it is impossible to define the infinite consciousness of Tao, inside within whose consciousness everything, including all concepts, resides. Tao possesses absolute freedom of choice, for there is nothing that could make its choice unfree. Since Tao within itself can only be conscious of itself, it possesses the highest self-consciousness, or the highest "I-consciousness." As Tao is All, it possesses the supreme knowledge called as *All Knowledge* or *omniscience*.

Despite its omniscience, there is always something that Tao does not know. That is the free choice of a being in advance. If Tao is conscious of a being with free choice, it can never know in advance what free choice that being will make through Tao. If the choice were known beforehand, it would not be free. A being's free choice already implies that the choice remains unknown until it is determined. Tao is always conscious of all possibilities of free choice - for it is All, and is always self-conscious - yet the being's actual free choice becomes known to Tao only when the being itself determines it. Hereafter, a being possessing free choice will be referred to as a *free being* or a *personality.*

Not only must all knowledge be contained inside Tao, but everything that might be unknown to Tao - all *unknowledge* - must also be contained inside Tao itself. If there is something unknown to Tao, the Tao must always be aware that it does not know that something. Such unknowledge is the free choice of a human being as a free being, as a personality. Indeed, since all knowledge now belongs to Tao, it is always aware of all the possibilities of free choice that a personality might select. A free choice that is unknown to Tao cannot be known to any other being either. However, the moment a personality makes a choice through Tao, that choice immediately becomes known to Tao, because the personality - as well as all possibilities of free choice - exists inside the consciousness of Tao.

Every being always has a beginning and an end and always exists inside the consciousness of Tao. The Tao itself is infinite and cannot be a finite being. Therefore, Tao can never know in advance what choice a personality will make. Since Tao is conscious of everything the personality is aware of, it is also conscious of unknowledge of personality. If there were no personalities, then through beings without free choice, Tao could only be conscious of its own infinite knowledge, because in a being without freedom, everything is already known to Tao.

Thus, unknowledge always exists inside Tao and transforms into knowledge only when personality makes a free choice. It would be a mistake to conclude that, simply because something unknown to Tao can become known through personality, the consciousness of Tao itself evolves. Concepts of development and change apply only to the finite consciousness of a being. The Tao’s infinite consciousness of all the possibilities and consequences of a personality’s free choice does not change when a choice is made, for they are always inside the consciousness of Tao. For this reason alone, it would be incorrect to claim that consciousness of Tao can evolve or change. Tao knows all things through infinite consciousness, yet it does not know all things through the finite consciousness of

personality. Were the Tao not to manifest itself within the personality, unknowledge could never become knowledge, and there would be no manifestation of the world structure in which personality could make free choice.

The concept of freedom of choice is inseparable from the concept of will. To manifest will means to make a choice through Tao. Therefore, freedom of choice and freedom of will signify the same thing. Consciousness always precedes the choice made, because before a free choice can be made at all, personality must be aware of at least two possible options. If only one possibility existed for the consciousness of personality, such a choice would not be free.

Consciousness and Tao are inseparable; therefore, the consciousness of a personality is always imbued with Tao, which possesses absolute free will. Consequently, the consciousness of a personality is always imbued with will, meaning that if a choice exists, personality is capable of making a free choice through Tao. Only beings without free choice can carry out any free choice made by personality. If only personalities existed, then any choice made by one personality would have to be executed by other personalities. This implies that those other personalities would lack free choice. Therefore, any manifested world structure must always consist of both personalities and beings without free choice.

Animals, for example, are beings without free choice. Suppose an animal is presented with two pieces of food - one of them poisoned - and consciousness (commonly termed "instinct") capable of identifying the poisoned piece. The animal will never eat the poisoned piece; instead, it will choose the other. An animal's actions are predetermined by instinct. Instinct is the consciousness of an entire species - or of animals of the same kind - that invariably dictates the actions of the individual of species. Instinct operates according to a predictable pattern. Human behavior, however, cannot be predicted in this way because humans possess free choice. Even if a personality knows which piece of food is poisoned, the choice is not predetermined yet.

In spiritual science, beings whose consciousness encompasses the consciousness of all animals of a single species are called group souls. An animal's instinct is the consciousness of that animal's group soul. Animal group souls do not possess freedom of choice; therefore, individual animals cannot possess freedom of choice either. It follows that a human being cannot have originated from an animal. A personality can only originate from those that possesses freedom of choice - that is, from Tao. The personality is made in the image and likeness of the absolute God, because God's freedom of choice is manifested in the personality's freedom of choice.

Only personality - and not the Tao, inside whose consciousness all possibilities of free choice reside - can ever be held responsible for the consequences of free choice. Free choice is always a cause that invariably and precisely leads to corresponding consequences. Therefore, in exercising free choice, a personality may suffer *from* that choice, rather than *for* it. To suffer *from* free choice means to suffer as a result of free choice acting as the cause. To suffer *for* free choice would imply the existence of punishment for making that choice. No such punishment can exist, for then the choice would not be free; instead, it would be predetermined by the prospect of punishment through suffering. This helps explain why the absolute God allows personalities to commit crimes, steal, lie, and inflict suffering upon one another: because otherwise, personalities would be deprived of free choice.

The Sanskrit word *karma* means "*deed*, *action*". Since any action would be predetermined in the absence of free will, *karma* always signifies a free action - that is, an action resulting from free choice. The relationship between the cause and effect of an personality's free choice is also known as the law of

destiny or the law of karma. In this sense, *karma* should always be understood as the consequences of actions stemming from free choice. Without free choice, there can be no karma.

The law of cause and effect inexorably leads the personality to the next free choice. The personality's successive free choices determine its destiny - its karma. It is impossible to predict a future free choice; one can only predict the consequences of such a choice. Therefore, religious sources that foretell the future can only indicate the consequences of free choices that personalities have already made.

When a personality suffers, it is said that it has bad karma. Whether a personality has bad or good karma depends solely on its free choice. Since animals lack free choice, they do not generate karma and should not suffer, as their actions are always dictated by instinct - which operates without free will. Instinct, for instance, always protects an animal from suffering; thus, an animal can never voluntarily choose to suffer. To understand what might cause animal suffering, let us consider the following statement.

Man is the only being with freedom of choice in the manifested world structure.

The second assertion provides an unequivocal characterization of the human being as a personality, making it possible to answer the question: "What is a human being?" A human being is a being possessed of free choice. If even a single personality exists, there must be a world structure in which that personality can become conscious of and make a free choice. Therefore, the "manifested world structure" will henceforth be understood as everything that a human being can possibly perceive through free choice. This also implies that all possibilities for free choice must already exist within the world structure, just as the world structure itself must exist within the consciousness of Tao. The world structure must also possess consciousness, because everything of what Tao is conscious of, possesses consciousness.

If there were no personalities within the manifested world structure, then such a world structure - lacking free choice itself - would contain no free life. Free life is the transformation of consciousness through free choice. The transformation of a personality's consciousness through free choice also implies that something previously unknown to Tao becomes known. A manifestation of the world structure without personalities would immediately come to an end, because in such a world structure, everything would already be known to Tao in advance. Therefore, a world structure without personalities cannot manifest. Likewise, personalities cannot manifest without a world structure that holds within its consciousness all the possibilities for their free choice.

The possession of free choice renders all personalities potentially equal regarding the free development of the ’I’-consciousness. This implies that every personality, without exception, must always have the potential to realize themselves as the absolute ’I’ - as Tao. Were this not the case, Tao - in order to avoid violating an personality's free choice - would have to act solely through beings without free choice, thereby forever depriving itself of free choice. Since this is impossible, there can be only one type of beings possessing the free choice who can develop consciousness and realize itself as Tao. The existence of two distinct types of personalities would imply inequality in the development of the ’I’-consciousness: one type would have the capacity to realize itself as the Tao, while the other would not. Human free choice allows to assert that man must be the only one free being in the manifested world structure.

The manifestation of a human being as a being with free choice entails the manifestation of all other beings without free choice, including animals. The free choice influences not only one’s own

consciousness but also the consciousness of other beings. Beings without free choice are always dependent on beings with free choice. Therefore, the cause of animal suffering can only be human free choice. This renders the human being responsible for the suffering not only of animals but of any being in the manifested world structure. From this, one can understand that the absolute God never punishes anyone; rather, it is solely the free choice of the personality that can be the cause of suffering.

Everything that can exist must possess consciousness, because everything resides within the consciousness of Tao, which is alway self-conscious. A man who acknowledges his own consciousness yet denies consciousness in the multiplicity of the external environment would be like someone who acknowledges the air in his lungs while denying the existence of air outside his physical body. The concept of a "being" is identical to the concept of "consciousness," in the sense that there are no beings without consciousness and no consciousness without beings to manifest it. Therefore, what can be chosen, developed, or altered in the manifested world structure is consciousness itself, for everything manifested appears as beings possessing varying levels of consciousness. Since everything possesses consciousness, and the manifested world structure consists of both beings with free choice and beings without it, all possibilities of the free choice can only be manifested through beings without free choice.

The manifestation or emanation of all beings occurs through the Tao’s realization within itself of beings with free choice. The concept of a "being" cannot be applied to the Tao, because it implies the finitude or limitation of consciousness. The consciousness of Tao is infinite; therefore, Tao is not a being, but every being always exists in the consciousness of Tao.

The word "self-consciousness" implies a duality of consciousness - the capacity to become conscious of oneself within oneself. That what Tao is conscious of in itself possesses consciousness itself and becomes a relative consciousness. Duality also signifies the existence of two opposites. A consequence of this duality of consciousness is the existence, in the manifested world structure, of both beings with free choice and beings without it.

If a human possesses free choice, then there must exist beings without free choice. The existence of beings with varying levels of consciousness implies the existence of hierarchies of beings - or hierarchies of consciousness. Hierarchies of beings without free choice cannot lie or deny what exists, for doing so would imply the possession of free choice. They can only be what they are conscious of. In this sense, the consciousness of beings without free choice is always true. A human comes to know the truth when they perceive what is perceived by hierarchies of consciousness without free choice. Since the consciousness of any being is finite, these hierarchies of consciousness can reflect only relative truth. A human can grasp the truth only gradually, by attaining various levels of the hierarchies of consciousness. To know absolute truth would mean knowing what Tao is conscious of, or attaining the realization of oneself as Tao.

The existence of hierarchies of consciousness makes it possible to answer the question: "Which came first - a chicken or an egg?" Neither. The egg and the chicken are distinct manifestations of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. Everything that is manifest is manifest through hierarchies of consciousness. Laws of nature are likewise relationships between hierarchies of consciousness without free choice. Natural science is possible only because there exist hierarchies of beings without free choice, the relationships between which can be predicted. Natural science investigates the relationships accessible to what is known as human waking - or daytimeconsciousness. Accessible to human waking consciousness are those relationships between hierarchies of consciousness known as the solid, liquid,

gaseous, and fiery states. In spiritual science, these four states of relationship between hierarchies of consciousness are termed Earth, Water, Air, and Fire.

If a man has developed spiritual or supersensible organs of perception, then the consciousness of dreaming sleep, dreamless sleep, and deep dreamless sleep can be integrated into his waking consciousness. Waking consciousness that incorporates the consciousness of dreaming sleep is termed *imaginative* consciousness. Waking consciousness that encompasses the consciousness of dreamless sleep is termed *inspirative* consciousness. Waking consciousness that includes the consciousness of deep dreamless sleep is termed *intuitive* consciousness. Imaginative consciousness perceives the consciousness of the hierarchies in animals. Inspirative consciousness perceives the consciousness of the hierarchies in plants. Intuitive consciousness perceives the consciousness of the hierarchies in minerals. For supersensible perception, the consciousness of all things is an immediate fact.

Everything that is manifested as hierarchies of consciousness can only have finite consciousness, because only Tao has infinite consciousness. Since the world structure is manifested, it must have consciousness, and its consciousness must be finite. This leads to the third statement.

Any manifested world structure is finite.

The finite nature of the world structure implies that the world structure has a beginning and an end. The manifestation of the world structure begins with Tao realizing within itself the personalities as beings with free choice. The world structure ends when personalities realize themselves as Tao. Since Tao is always self-conscious and its consciousness is infinite, countless manifested world structures have already existed. In the infinity of Tao’s consciousness, there can be no first or last world structure. Therefore, there always exist countless possibilities for the manifestation of world structures in which personalities have not yet realized themselves as Tao through free choice. Consequently, the past, present, and future are inextricably linked to the individual's free choice. Without free choice of personality, there would be neither past, present, nor future, for everything would be known to Tao in advance.

The third assertion can also be stated as follows:

The number of personalities in any manifested world structure is finite.

Let us assume that the manifested world structure is finite, yet the number of personalities in it were infinite. In that case, there would always be personalities with distinct consciousnesses who had not yet made the possible free choice - and, consequently, had not realized themselves as Tao. Such a world structure would never come to an end, which contradicts the premise that the world structure is finite. Therefore, the number of personalities - as beings possessing free choice - must always be finite in any manifested world structure.

Conversely, if we assume that the number of personalities in the manifested world structure is always finite, then the world structure itself must also be finite. An infinite world structure would consist of countless possibilities for free choice of personalities. The free choice of personalities in an infinite universe would never come to an end, and personalities would never be able to realize themselves as Tao. It follows, then, that Tao would forever deprive itself of free choice by manifesting that freedom through personalities. Thus, the manifested world structure is always realized by Tao as an being whose consciousness is composed of the finite set of all possibilities that personalities can choose in order to

realize themselves as Tao. Since the world structure and personalities cannot manifest without one another, both versions of the third assertion are equivalent.

The word "monad," translated from Greek, signifies "unit" or "the one" and implies indivisibility - in the sense that nothing can be separated from the unified whole without destroying that unity. The word "individuality," translated from Latin, signifies "indivisibility" and, in this sense, denotes the same concept as the monad. The concepts of individuality and monad should be understood namely as a whole from which nothing can be separated without destroying its unity.

Man realizes himself as a separate being, as the "I." This means he possess self-consciousness - the "I-am" consciousness or the "I-consciousness." The highest "I-consciousness" has Tao, which is indivisible; because nothing can be separated from it, and it constitutes an absolute individuality. Therefore, a man's true "I" - or true self - can only be that absolute individuality which is Tao.

The highest "I" of man is manifested in the world structure as his individuality. The individuality of man can also be defined as the highest "I-consciousness." a man can have in the manifested world structure. In order all personalities to be equally free, their individualities must be potentially equal. This is possible if each individuality encompasses all the possibilities of free choice available to the personality. The full range of possibilities for a personality's free choice remains constant in the manifested world structure; in this sense, individuality, too, remains unchanged in the manifested cosmos.

The extent to which a man is conscious of himself as individuality defines him as personality. A human being is together individuality, personality, and the relationships between hierarchies of consciousness manifested through free choice. There is an ancient knowledge that a man consists of spirit, soul, and body. Individuality corresponds to the spirit. Personality corresponds to the soul. The body corresponds to karma - or the relationships between hierarchies of consciousness manifested through free choice.

Personality is defined by consciousness of man and, consequently, changes evolving through the free choice. A man's individuality is his highest manifested "I"; it is indivisible and constitutes the principle of personality. Personality cannot be separated from individuality, just as individuality cannot be separated from mankind. The consciousness that Tao realizes in itself as the consciousness of all personalities must be understood as the consciousness of mankind. Mankind is not merely the aggregate of all personalities; rather, mankind is a being whose consciousness encompasses the consciousness of every personality. Before a personality can be manifested, mankind must be manifested as a being possessing the free choice of all personalities. When the consciousness of each personality attains the awareness of its own individuality, the end of the world structure arrives, and all personalities attain the realization of themselves as an absolute, unified individuality - as the absolute "I", as Tao. This marks the return of individuality - or the human monad - to its source: the absolute Deity.

The concepts of consciousness and free will are fundamental to understanding the possibility of the beginning and end of the manifested world structure. The world structure begins with the Tao’s free choice to manifest in itself personalities as beings with free choice. The world structure exists as long as there remains even a single personality that has not yet attained the realization of itself as an individuality in the manifested world structure. The world structure comes to an end through the free choice of every personality to realize itself as the absolute individuality that is Tao. This is possible

only when every personality has already attained the highest consciousness of itself as an individuality in the manifested world structure. Only then can one personality, as an individuality, realize all other personalities as individualities. If even a single personality lacks this highest consciousness of self as an individuality, it implies that no other personality possesses such highest consciousness either, given the potential equality of individualities. Therefore, a single personality's realization of itself as Tao can occur only in conjunction with all other personalities. This means that no man can merge with Tao - that is, realize itself as Tao - until another man is also able to merge with Tao.

The number of personalities must be finite in any manifested world structure. Yet, this number must also differ across different world structures. If the number of personalities in a preceding and a succeeding world structure were identical, they would constitute the very same personalities, given the potential equality of individualities. Consequently, both world structures would be exactly the same. Any choice made would not be free, but rather predetermined by the previous world structure; therefore, such a succeeding world structure cannot come into manifestation.

As distinct beings, personalities must possess distinct consciousness. Personalities may share the same level of consciousness, yet their consciousness remain distinct. This implies that, in the manifested world structure, there always exist personalities possessing higher or lower levels of consciousness. Consequently, there must also exist a personality in our manifested world structure that has the highest consciousness of self as an individuality. This is the personality referred to in the New Testament as Jesus Christ. The name "Jesus" corresponds to the consciousness of personality, while "Christ" corresponds to the consciousness of individuality - representing the highest self-consciousness in our manifested world structure.

The existence of personality's freedom of choice allows us to pose a question to which there can be no answer in the manifested world structure:

What is the number of personalities in the manifested world structure?

The number of personalities in the manifested world structure is always finite. This number is known only to the infinite consciousness of Tao, which realizes in itself every personality as a being with free choice. To know the total number of personalities without violating the free choice, one must has a consciousness that encompasses all individualities. Such a consciousness of all individualities can be attained only through all personalities together. If all personalities were already conscious of themselves as individualities, then all possible choices and their consequences would be known to them in advance, and their choices would not be free. Consequently, a personality's freedom of choice implies that personality cannot know the finite number of all personalities in the manifested world structure. The answer will be revealed to all personalities only when each one has attained the highest consciousness of itself as an individuality within the manifested world structure. Only then can each personality, as an individuality, realize itself as the Tao and perceive all other personalities as individualities - thereby coming to know the number of personalities in the manifested world structure.

The finite number of personalities is a numerical characteristic of the world structure. It allows us to define the center of the manifested world structure. Since everything possesses consciousness, the center of the manifested world structure is that level of consciousness at which it is possible to know the finite number of personalities within the manifested world structure. At this level of consciousness, each personality realizes itself as an individuality, and all personalities together can realize themselves as an absolute individuality. This number lies at the foundation of all relationships between hierarchies of consciousness, regardless of whether or not they can be expressed in numerical terms. Without a

finite number of personalities in the manifested world structure, there can be no manifestation of the world structure. Without a manifested world structure, there can be no science. Therefore, knowledge of the existence of a finite number of personalities in the manifested world structure lies at the base of the science of the Tao.

The Involution

The Tao begot One. One begot Two. Two begot Three. And Three begot the ten thousand things.

(Tao Te Ching 道德經 42)

The freedom of choice of Tao to manifest in itself finite number of personalities was referred to as an infinite cause of emanation of the world structure. Because there is nothing unconscious, this free choice manifests first being, whose consciousness is divine plan, or idea of the development of the world structure. The word *idea* is used for description of being with finite consciousness which contains all possibilities of manifestation. The separated personalities are not manifested yet and exist as principles of personalities, as individualities. Consciousness of this manifested being is consciousness of all individualities. Consciousness of all individualities that contains all possibilities of free choice of all personalities is consciousness of mankind. To fulfil divine plan, mankind has the freedom of choice of all personalities.

The fulfilment of divine plan occurs in states of involution and evolution. The concept of *involution* signifies envelopment, folding inwards, and *evolution* signifies unfolding. Because everything has consciousness, involution signifies envelopment of consciousness, and evolution signifies unfolding of consciousness. Envelopment and unfolding of consciousness are connected with the freedom of choice. The free choice of Tao to become conscious in itself of manifestation of personalities, leads to manifestation of the world structure. Manifestation of consciousness of separated personalities corresponds to involution, because infinite consciousness of Tao is folding into finite consciousness of personalities through free choice of mankind. Free choice of separated personalities in the world structure corresponds to evolution because finite consciousness of personalities is unfolding into infinite consciousness of Tao. Involution and evolution of consciousness are inseparable from the freedom of choice.

So that all personalities are to be manifested equally free, they must themselves determine which consciousness every separately manifested personality will have in order to make its first free choice. This can do only all personalities together, as whole mankind, as one being. If mankind not by itself choose with what consciousness every separated personality will start to make its free choice, then the choice of all personalities, as of whole mankind would be not free and predetermined by Tao from the beginning. Then the first choice of every separately manifested personality would be not free also, what would contradict to the freedom of choice of personality. Therefore, the free choice of Tao to become conscious in itself of manifestation of finite number of personalities manifests mankind, as one being with the freedom of choice of all personalities. This free choice of Tao is called *great sacrifice* because now only mankind can make free choice through Tao.

The trinity

All conceptions which deserve of attention and which make an attempt to explain manifestation of the world structure refer to necessity of trinity. Therefore, all such conceptions can be characterized by one general statement, expressing the main idea of the emanation of the world structure:

One manifests Two; Two manifest Three; Three manifest the world structure.

The emanation of the world structure from and in Tao is possible because an object which Tao is conscious of in itself has consciousness and becomes subject of consciousness. Herein it is included possibility that manifested One becomes Two. However, One must be manifested first before Two can be manifested. Manifested One is not Tao because Tao is infinite, and something manifested can be only a being with finite consciousness. Manifested One can contain only one manifested world structure and only finite number of personalities in its finite consciousness. Infinite consciousness of Tao contains all countless possibilities of manifestation of the world structures and personalities.

Manifestation of One, as being with finite consciousness, begins with free choice of Tao to become conscious in itself of finite number of personalities. The result of such consciousness is manifestation which itself has consciousness and which is called *mankind*. This is manifested One.

To manifest something it is possible only through the free choice. In order to make free choice, it is necessary to have the freedom of choice. Therefore, the freedom of choice must exist in all three elements of the trinity, so that the world structure could be manifested, in which finite number of personalities have freedom of choice. Because mankind is always first manifested being with freedom of choice of all personalities, it is possible to make the following statement:

Free mankind, which is conscious of itself as Unity is One.

Mankind has divine plan of the development of all possibilities of consciousness of personalities in itself. Which number of personalities must be manifested is predetermined through free choice of Tao in advance. All possibilities of any choice of personalities are also predetermined through individualities in advance. However, which relations of consciousness will be manifested between personalities, which consciousness will have every separately manifested personality, all personalities must determine together, as one whole mankind.

Manifestation of separated personalities can occur only together with manifestation of hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. So that equally free personalities and hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice, as all possibilities of free choice of personalities, have to be manifested, it is necessary that whole mankind is conscious of duality in itself. One element of duality must correspond to all personalities with freedom of choice, and another element of duality must correspond to all hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. Possibility for mankind to become conscious in itself of duality exists, as consequence of self-consciousness. Mankind cannot be not conscious of duality in itself because it has self-consciousness, mankind, however, has freedom to choose how to be conscious of duality in itself. To become conscious in itself of duality it is necessary for manifestation of the world structure. However, mankind makes its free choice to determine which relations will be manifested between elements of duality.

The free choice of mankind as One allows to become conscious of such possibilities of manifestation of all relations between two elements of duality which are most suitable for manifestation of separated free personalities. Such free choice is made from knowledge of all possibilities of free choice of all personalities. The free choice of mankind as One, allows mankind to become conscious of itself as Two. Personalities and hierarchies of consciousness exist in consciousness of mankind as two original principles. Hence, the following statement:

Free mankind, which is conscious of itself as Duality is Two.

To become conscious in itself of duality it is not enough for manifestation of plenty of beings in the world structure yet. For this purpose it is necessary that mankind becomes conscious of trinity in itself. The possibility to become conscious of the trinity in itself exists because mankind does not lose consciousness of itself as One. Mankind is conscious of itself as One and as Two together. To be conscious of itself as One and as Two together means to become conscious of itself as Three. Mankind makes free choice of which relations of consciousness will be manifested between the elements of trinity. Therefore, it is possible to make one more statement:

Free mankind, which is conscious of itself as Trinity is Three.

Involution of consciousnesses of mankind occurs through free choice of mankind as one being, consisting of all individualities. All individualities are potentially equal and contain all possibilities of free choice of all personalities. Involution of consciousness consists of that, that mankind becomes conscious in itself of principles or ideas that can be manifested in evolution beside each other and in each other. The purpose is manifestation of separated personalities with freedom of choice and of hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice.

Mankind becomes conscious of itself as One, Two and Three together. The state of consciousness as One is attained together with state of consciousness as Two and together with state of consciousness as Three. Therefore all states of consciousness exist always together, in each other and beside each other. This means Three are One.

There are no contradictions between spiritual science and ancient scriptures. Ancient writings, however, do not refer to the freedom of choice directly. The reason for it is that waking consciousness of man was not developed so far yet, that it was possible to speak about freedom of choice directly. Therefore ancient scriptures mention the freedom of choice indirectly. Consciousness of man, however, has changed. Responsibility of personality for its free choice changes accordingly to its consciousness. To point out to the freedom of choice became necessary because further destiny of mankind on the Earth depends on that, that every single personality will become conscious of consequences of its free choice.

The mutual existence of three states of consciousness of mankind as One, Two and Three leads to further involution of principles of consciousness, life and form. From any three elements (a, b, c), without consideration of their order, it is possible to form only seven different combinations (a, b, c, ab, bc, ac, abc). Therefore, consciousness by which mankind becomes conscious of trinity determines sevenness of consciousness. Mankind becomes conscious of trinity in itself and through trinity becomes conscious of itself, what creates seven combinations of consciousness. Free choice of mankind determines which relations of consciousness will be manifested between all possible combinations of consciousness of trinity. The result of free choice of mankind is seven combinations of consciousness of trinity, or seven principles.

These seven principles must be think of as the existing beings; as the relationships of consciousness of trinity, manifested in seven essential forms of consciousness.

1. a - All Might
2. b - All Wisdom
3. c - All Love

4. ab - All Justice
5. bc - All Redemption
6. ac - All Hallowing
7. abc - All Harmony

The world structure will be manifested when plenty of hierarchies of consciousness will be manifested. This occurs whilst mankind becomes conscious of plenty of principles in itself. Mankind becomes conscious of itself as One, Two, Three and so on. Further involution of consciousness occurs whilst mankind becomes conscious of sevenness, or of seven creative spirits before the throne of God.

Before seven spirits of God can be manifested during evolution, they all must become conscious to mankind as principles during involution. Because single personalities are not manifested yet, involution of consciousness of mankind occurs through free choice of whole mankind, and not through free choice of single personalities. The result of such mutual free choice of mankind, are principles of consciousness, life and form. Mankind becomes conscious of principles in itself which can be manifested as beings with self-consciousness. Beside principles with lower consciousness mankind becomes conscious of principles with higher consciousness in itself. In such a way, involution of consciousness of mankind is involution of principles.

Consciousness of modern man in physical body allows him to make distinction between space and time. Awareness of space is connected with manifestation of different relations between hierarchies of consciousness beside each other and in each other. Successive repetition of changes of relations between hierarchies of consciousness following one after another, leads to awareness of time. Personalities can become conscious of space and time only together with manifestation of hierarchies of consciousness. In this sense involution of consciousness of mankind is also process of wrapping up of infinite consciousness of Tao into space and time. In state of involution personalities and hierarchies of consciousness have no independent existence yet because they are only parts of consciousness of mankind. Therefore, the state of involution of consciousness of mankind is timeless and spaceless. Time and space will be manifested only in the state of evolution and exist beside each other and in each other.

The purpose of involution of consciousness of mankind is manifestation of single personalities which are able to make their free choice. Evolution of consciousness of personalities begins with manifestation of single personalities. Because involution and evolution of consciousness are inseparable from the freedom of choice, they cannot exist without each other also. The free choice of mankind in state of involution leads to free choice of personalities in state of evolution. The change of two states of consciousness, such as for example, involution and evolution is *rhythm*, or *cycle* of consciousness.

The rhythms

In any rhythm or cycle there are always two alternating states as result of principle of duality. These two states can be considered as two opposites. Because there is nothing unconscious, rhythm can be defined as alternation or change of two states of consciousness. Such events as day and night, in-breathing and out-breathing, yin and yang and so on, are rhythms of consciousness also.

Esoteric philosophy of all times describes life of the world structure, as rhythmic life. Indian philosophy, for example, speaks of inhalation and exhalation of One. The One experiences different states of its divine life. These states are compared to in-breathing and out-breathing. Out-breathing of

the One corresponds to manifestation of the world structure from Tao and in-breathing corresponds to state of dissolution of the world structure in Tao. Thus alternate the manifested and not manifested world structure, states of activity and rest. Manvantara is state of activity and Pralaya is the state of the One, resting in himself.

Basic or main rhythm of the world structure is determined by two states of consciousness, by the state of consciousness where Tao is conscious in itself of personalities, as beings with freedom of choice, and by state of consciousness where all personalities are conscious of themselves as Tao. This corresponds to manifestation of the world structure from Tao and to dissolution of the world structure in Tao. It is necessary to emphasize again that manifestation of any rhythm is result of free choice. The main rhythm is result of free choice of Tao to be conscious of finite number of personalities in itself as well as result of the free choice of all personalities to become conscious of themselves as Tao.

The numerical characteristic of this rhythm is finite number of personalities in the manifested world structure. Because manifestation of finite number of separated personalities occurs only after completion of involution of consciousness of mankind, all rhythms that could be manifested in the world structure must become conscious to mankind in state of involution. Because in the world structure must be manifested personalities with the freedom of choice and hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice, all rhythms must be manifested through hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. In state of involution mankind becomes conscious of different rhythms of consciousness, life and form which all separated personalities must experience during involution in order to become conscious of themselves as Tao.

The state of involution of consciousness of mankind is timeless and spaceless. Space and time are manifested only in state of evolution. Evolution of consciousness of personalities occurs in space and time. Involution and evolution together form creative activity of the manifested world structure. According to Indian philosophy the creative cycle of activity must be replaced by creative inactivity in which manifested world structure is dissolved in Tao. Besides, it is mentioned that states of creative activity - Manvantara and inactivity - Pralaya have same duration.

In state of involution all personalities create no Karma yet, but free choice of mankind prepares conditions for free choice of separated personalities in evolution. Karma can be created by single personalities only in state of evolution. Therefore, state of involution can be compared with state of Pralaya, and state of evolution with state of Manvantara.

It is necessary to point out to certain difficulty which arises already by comparison of duration of involution and evolution. Involution occurs prior to manifestation of time and space. Evolution occurs in time and space. It is possible to compare only by units of time and space. Such units of comparison are rhythms which are manifested only in state of evolution. However in state of involution rhythms are not manifested yet, neither time nor space is manifested, therefore, it is impossible to compare duration of involution and evolution. Nevertheless it is possible to claim that all rhythms which mankind became conscious of in state of involution will become conscious to separated personalities in state of evolution. And in this sense it is possible to claim that involution and evolution have equal duration.

Still bigger difficulty arises by attempt to compare duration of state of the manifested world structure and duration of state in which the world structure is dissolved in Tao. Such state is also called Maha-Pralaya in Indian philosophy. Is it possible to compare the state of infinite loneliness and oneness of Tao in rhythms of the manifested world structure whose source is Tao? Indian philosophy, for

example, specifies duration of our world structure in terrestrial years and equates their number to duration of Maha-Pralaya.

Similar calculations could be found in the second volume of *Secret Doctrine* where the number equal to 311040×10^9 terrestrial years is given. Although various calculations can differ from each other, their sense remains the same. All calculations express duration of the world structure in finite number of terrestrial years and equate it to the state of Maha-Pralaya when no world structure is manifested, when Tao dwells in its infinite loneliness and oneness.

If to suppose Tao dwells in its infinite loneliness and oneness exactly as much terrestrial years as the world structure can last, then it would mean Tao is subjected to some rhythm. Tao is source of any rhythm and can not be subjected to rhythm. May Tao, who is always conscious in itself of all possibilities of manifestation of all world structures, to be in need of such state whose duration could be measured by finite number of terrestrial days, before next world structure is manifested? If Tao is always conscious of all possibilities of manifestation of next world structure, then the state of Maha-Pralaya could pass over into state of involution at once. Even if certain pause existed between the end of preceding world structure and the beginning of next world structure, it would be impossible to measure it by units of the manifested world structure. Therefore, any such calculations can be only characteristics of the manifested world structure. In this sense that number of the terrestrial years is characteristics of number of rhythms which every personality must experience in order to become conscious of itself as Tao.

However between the states in which the world structure is manifested and is not manifested, there always exist relations to which it is possible to point out. On the one hand, in not manifested world structure all possible results of free choice are known to Tao, but free choice itself cannot be made by single personalities, because they are not manifested yet. On the other hand, in the manifested world structure, all possible results of any free choice are unknown to personalities, but free choice itself can be made. These two sides express relations which can be considered equal for manifested and not manifested world structure. These relations always exist because in infinite consciousness of Tao always exist possibilities of manifestation of new world structures.

The world structure comes to an end when every personality becomes conscious of itself as Tao. Only then the finite number of personalities can become known to every personality in the manifested world structure. Therefore, no being in the manifested world structure can know what the next world structure will be. There is no possibility to compare the present and next world structures because it is not known what may be manifested in next world structure. It is possible, however, to state, that next manifested world structure never repeats itself because the number of personalities is always different in any world structure. Next world structure cannot contain something that was already recognized by personalities through free choice in uncountable preceding world structures. Otherwise it would be known to Tao in advance which choice personalities will make and such choice would not be free. The true ‘I’ or Self of personality is Tao. Therefore, the ‘I’ of man was always manifested in personalities in preceding world structures and always will be manifested in personalities in following world structures. Knowledge about preceding and next world structure is beyond consciousness of single personality in the manifested world structure.

Free choice of mankind in state of involution leads to further awareness of mankind of principles of consciousness, life and form. The state of involution is purely internal state where nothing is manifested externally yet, and everything what will be manifested is in consciousness of mankind. Neither principles, nor single personalities have independent existence yet. Principles get independent

existence together with the manifestation of single personalities. Manifestation of single personalities signifies beginning of evolution. On transition from involution to evolution mostly lowest state of principles of consciousness, life and form is attained. This lowest state is always higher than any state of evolving single personalities and principles.

The Evolution

The ten thousand things carry yin and embrace yang.

(Tao Te Ching 道德經 42)

To the end of involution mankind is conscious of all principles which can be manifested as separated beings in the state of evolution. This state could be called a *pause*.

Such a pause does not mean inactivity, but only some intermediate state of consciousness of mankind between involution and evolution. It is necessary in order that all personalities could determine with which consciousness they will be manifested. Personalities have now such consciousness that allows them to be conscious of all possibilities of manifestation of principles of consciousness, life and form. This allows them also momentarily to become conscious of all possible consequences of free choice. Therefore, the first free choice in pause between involution and evolution all personalities can make together. If first free choice would not be made by all personalities together, then the choice of one personality could predetermine the choice of another personality what would contradict the freedom of choice.

The first free choice signifies beginning of evolution and is choice to manifest personalities, as single separated beings. In involution consciousness and will of all personalities were still manifested as uniform consciousness and will of whole mankind. In evolution consciousness and will of mankind are manifested in personalities and in different principles through the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. Personalities can make now their free choice, according to their consciousness and will. Single principles are manifested as beings, whose consciousness is expressed in different *rhythms* or *cycles*. Therefore, evolution in the world structure can be described proceeding from rhythms of oneness, duality, trinity and so on.

Three kingdoms of consciousness

Separated personalities were manifested on different stages of the hierarchies of consciousness. The stages of consciousness of the hierarchies differ from each other by the stages of conscious following to rhythms of the development of consciousness of the world structure. One of such rhythms is rhythm of *trinity* or *Holy Trinity.* According to this rhythm three are manifested three kingdoms of consciousness.

The first free choice of all personalities manifested three kingdoms and determined in which kingdom and with which consciousness every personality is manifested. Because personalities are manifested with different consciousness, there must be manifested personality with the highest consciousness in each kingdom. The names of these personalities are known as kings: *Michael, Lucifer* and *Uriel*.

Lucifer also is called *devil* what literally means the *'fallen God'*. Being without freedom of choice cannot fall by itself because action scheme of such a being is always predetermined in advance. Only free choice of Lucifer could lead him to that, what is called the *fall*. Besides, the name Lucifer signifies

the *'bearer of light'* or the *'light-bearer'*. In the beginning of evolution Lucifer had the highest consciousness among all personalities. The consequence of the fall of Lucifer is that he is not personality with the highest consciousness any more. The highest consciousness has Jesus Christ. This does not mean Lucifer has lost his consciousness or his high wisdom. This means Jesus Christ has developed his consciousness so far, that it became higher than consciousness of any personality in our world structure.

All personalities together have made their free choice, which allowed Lucifer to have the highest consciousness among personalities. Some personalities manifested themselves on lower stage of consciousness and have allowed other personalities to manifest themselves on higher stage of consciousness and vice versa. All personalities have made their mutual sacrifice, because they have made their first free choice together. No personality was forced by another personality to its choice and all personalities remained equally free. Therefore, personalities on lower stage of consciousness can develop their consciousness even more quickly than personalities, which are manifested on higher stage of consciousness. In other words, the speed of the development of consciousness depends not so much on stage of consciousness on which personalities are manifested, but rather depends on which free choice will be made.

Because any personality is member of whole mankind, any free choice of personality always exercises influence over the development of consciousness of other personalities. The higher is stage of consciousness of personality, the more influence can be exercised and the more responsibility personality has in determination of its choice. Responsibility of personality is determined by Karma to which free choice of personality leads. Beside individual Karma, all personalities, without exception, create Karma of mankind.

Lucifer had possibility to allow personalities in his kingdom, to manifest only those relations with beings of the hierarchies, whose consequences he himself could foresee. According to his stage of consciousness Lucifer has chosen to remove restrictions on connection of personality with beings of the hierarchies. This allows personalities in kingdom of Lucifer to become dependent on connection with beings of the hierarchies and to manifest greatest evil.

It is possible to give an example of manifestation of good and evil. If child is fed with spoon, when it cannot do this yet by itself, then it is good. If this is continued when child is already in a state to do it by itself, then it would be evil, because that will not correspond to the development of consciousness of child in rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. One and the same action with the same intention of good can manifest good in one state of consciousness, and in other state of consciousness be evil. The following saying points to connection between good and evil: "*The road to hell is paved with good intentions*".

Speaking in general, if free choice of personality does not correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, then it is evil. Free choice of personality which leads to manifestation of evil means separation of consciousness of personality from consciousness of mankind, through connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. It is expressed in that, that personality strives for satisfaction of egoism without taking into consideration other personalities. The more is separation, the more is evil which can be manifested by personality through its free choice. To balance result of the greatest separation of personalities, it is also necessary through free choice to manifest the greatest good that leads all personalities to consciousness of unity of mankind. In this sense, the greatest evil exists in order to manifest the greatest good.

Lucifer had possibility to restrict connection of personality with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, not allowing personality to become dependent on beings. Just as Tao allows mankind to be free in its choice of the development of consciousness, Lucifer also allows personalities in his kingdom to be free in the development of consciousness through manifestation of good and evil. Tao, however, has infinite consciousness and knows all possible consequences of any free choice. In spite of fact, that consciousness of Lucifer was the highest, it is still finite, therefore, he could not foresee all possible consequences of his free choice. The free choice of Lucifer has led to that what one calls the *fall*.

The fall signifies that Lucifer could not counterbalance relations between personality and beings of the hierarchies in such a way, that personality could develop the 'I'-consciousness keeping independence from beings of the hierarchies. The free choice of personality, which owing to decision of Lucifier manifests evil, creates Karma not only for personality, but also for Lucifer. Lucifer has become dependent on connections with beings of the hierarchies, which were manifested as result of free choice of other personalities. He became unfree and hence has fallen in a sense, that he could not counterbalance manifestation of evil, and in such a way to prevent influence of evil on himself.

In the kingdom of Lucifer there exists one personality which has used the choice of Lucifer in order to attain the highest consciousness of separation from mankind. This personality is called the *devil*, *Mephistopheles*, *Ahriman*. One should make distinction between the concepts of *devil* and *Satan*. Devil signifies *'fallen God'* and is referred to Lucifer. Satan signifies those, who *'leads away from the God'* or who *'separates from God'*. In New Testament the words devil and Satan point accordingly to Lucifer and Ahriman.

The development of consciousness of personality in every kingdom has property which depends on consciousness of king. To understand better specific properties of the development of consciousness of personality in every kingdom, one can use the following analogy. The kingdoms of Michael, Lucifer and Uriel can be considered as three schools of the development of consciousness accordingly. In each school there are director, teachers and disciples. Director has the highest consciousness on which depends the education in school. In first school director gives teachers instructions what must be educated. Teachers carry out instructions of director without any objection, not because they have no personal opinion, but because consciousness of director is superior to consciousness of each teacher and he knows much more, than they do. In third school director consults with teachers, before they get instructions from him. This makes the main difference between first and third schools. Disciples, according to their level of consciousness, fulfil instructions of teachers. The development of consciousness of disciples in first and third schools occurs relatively slow. To accelerate the development of consciousness, director of second school makes decision to allow disciples to change conditions of education in his school. Conditions of education can be changed so far, that director becomes unable to conduct education. In this case someone else should take control over education.

Michael and Uriel made their choice which does not allow personality to manifest evil in their kingdoms. Personalities in kingdoms of Michael and Uriel have possibility to become conscious of evil through what corresponds to the concepts of contemplation, meditation or reasoning (thinking) in our kingdom of Lucifer. However one should not imagine that consciousness of modern man on the Earth is the same, as consciousness of personalities in kingdoms of Michael and Uriel. The lowest stage of consciousness of personality in their kingdoms is comparable with the stage of consciousness of Angel. Personalities on the stage of consciousness of Angel do not need to be manifested in physical body. Their free choice does not manifest such relations with the hierarchies of consciousness as physical birth, illness or death. They cannot impose sufferings on other personalities, but they can think about

them and experience them through reflection. Because of that, the development of consciousness in kingdoms of Michael and Uriel occurs more slowly, than in kingdom of Lucifer. It is much faster to manifest good or evil through choice and to experience its consequences than to become conscious of all consequences of free choice through reflection. Confirmation for that is also Jesus Christ who was manifested in kingdom of Lucifer and has become personality whose consciousness is the highest in our world structure. Consciousness of Jesus Christ permeates through all three kingdoms, whilst consciousness of one king does not permeate through other kingdoms.

Because Lucifer allowed personalities in his kingdom to manifest evil without restrictions, he has deprived himself of possibility to counterbalance evil. In order any personality always could have possibility to become conscious of itself as Tao, another personality must counterbalance evil with good in the kingdom of Lucifer. This personality is Jesus Christ. Thereby, nobody is deprived of freedom of choice to manifest evil. To manifest evil means also to manifest opposites by opposing consciousness of some beings to consciousness of other beings. Michael and Uriel have preserved their power to counterbalance relations between beings in their kingdoms. Lucifer also had such a power before his fall.

The hierarchies of consciousness

Everything what man perceives through physical sense organs is only external expression of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. The hierarchy of consciousness consists of beings of one kind which are comprised in consciousness of being which one calls *Hierarch*. Hierarch has highest consciousness in the hierarchy. Being with higher consciousness is able to become conscious of what a being with lower consciousness is able to become conscious of too. Therefore, Hierarch is always conscious of what single being of the hierarchy is conscious of. For example, any fire on the Earth is comprised in consciousness of Hierarch which the Indian tradition calls *Agni*. Agni is Hierarch of all beings of the element of Fire on the Earth.

Indivisibility is inherent in hierarchies of consciousness. For example, the hierarchy of Angels signifies all Angels that are united through consciousness of the Hierarch of Angels. The hierarchy is indivisible whole in a sense that single Angel cannot exist without other Angels of the hierarchy.

Man as only being with freedom of choice, forms his own hierarchy of consciousness, which is *mankind*. Unlike other hierarchies of consciousness, each member of mankind has freedom of choice and consequently has its own Hierarch. Hierarch of man is his individuality, his highest ‘I’ (Self) in the manifested world structure. Man cannot exist separated from his individuality, and individuality cannot exist separated from mankind. Consciousness of mankind is united consciousness of all human Hierarchs.

The teaching about the hierarchies of consciousness, as beings without freedom of choice, is a teaching about gods. There are known three hierarchies of consciousness., named as follows.

1st Hierarchy
Spirits of Love (Seraphims)
Spirits of Harmony (Cherubims)
Spirits of Will (Thrones)
2nd Hierarchy
Spirits of Wisdom (Dominions, Kyriotetes)
Spirits of Movement (Mights, Virtutes, Dynamis)

Spirits of Form (Powers, Potestates, Exusiai)
3rd Hierarchy
Spirits of Personality (Primal Beginnings, Beginnings, Archai)
Spirits of Fire, Messangers of Archai (Archangel, Archangeloi)
Sons of Life, Messangers (Angels, Angeloi)

Beings without freedom of choice can have consciousness higher and lower than consciousness of man. Those beings whose consciousness is higher than consciousness of man are called the *heavenly beings* or *Devas*.

Similar to God can be only such being which has freedom of choice. Because the hierarchies of consciousness do not have freedom of choice, the similarity and union of hierarchy with God can occur only through free choice of personality. The consequence of the free choice of personality is the development of consciousness of personality, as well as of the hierarchies of consciousness. The higher is consciousness of personality the more it is conscious of possibilities of free choice. Because all possibilities of choice are manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness, the development of consciousness of personality occurs through inclusion of consciousness of beings of the hierarchies in consciousness of personality. If, for example, consciousness of personality encloses consciousness of Angel in itself, then it can become conscious of that, what Angel is conscious of. Consciousness of personality can be limited only by consciousness of the world structure. The end of the world structure can be reached only if consciousness of every personality is developed so far that it is conscious of all what can be conscious to all hierarchies. In such a way, personality with its consciousness can become superior to consciousness of any hierarchies or their combinations.

The luciferic and ahrimanic beings

The idea of the development of the world structure is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness which provide possibilities of free choice to personalities. In the beginning of evolution Michael, Lucifier and Uriel were the first among personalities who were conscious of the idea of the development of the world structure. Their free choice manifested new possibilities of choice for other personalities.

That man is conscious only of the physical world, results from his free choice. If free choice of man manifests evil, then this choice opposes consciousness of some beings of the hierarchies to consciousness of other beings, whose consciousness is lower, than consciousness of man. Possibility of such a choice has been manifested by Lucifier and Ahriman, therefore unfree beings, whose consciousness becomes opposed or set against to consciousness of other unfree beings, are called *luciferic* and *ahrimanic* beings. These beings also are called *devilish* and *satanic* beings. Man bears responsibility for opposition of consciousnesses of beings of the hierarchies against each other and, hence, for manifestation of devilish and satanic consciousness. Free choice of man corresponds to truth if it corresponds to consciousness of beings of the heavenly hierarchies, whose consciousness is higher, than consciousness of man. Such free choice heightens consciousness of man because consciousness of a heavenly being will be included in consciousness of man.

The presence of consciousness of devilish and satanic beings in consciousness of man is expressed in changes of consciousness which are called suffering, illness, old age, birth and death. If man were able to counterbalance connection with these beings according to consciousness of heavenly beings, then instead of birth and death he would experience a metamorphosis of one state of consciousness into

another. Because man cannot do it by himself, then in order not to become completely dependent from devilish and satanic beings, his consciousness is limited by perception of physical world only.

The free choice of man always manifests certain relations between the hierarchies of consciousness and man. There occurs an exchange of consciousness. As result, single beings will be manifested which can influence next free choice of man. Beings themselves have no freedom of choice, therefore their consciousness is true. Lie is negation of reality. Therefore, if man lies he manifests beings whose consciousness truly reflects lie of man. They influence consciousness of other men so that lie which is truly reflected by consciousness of beings, will be perceived as truth, that is as influence of consciousness of heavenly beings. The strength of such influence depends on how much manifested beings can use consciousness of man. The more man lies, the stronger becomes influence of beings and the stronger will be dependence of man from beings. Similar occurs, when man is mistaken, that is when it unintentionally lies to himself. The main difference between mistake and lie is that consequences of mistake are less destructive for consciousness of man, than consequences of lie.

Typical example of dependence from beings is desire to experience pleasure just for the sake of pleasure. In this case, an influence of manifested beings works as temptation. Temptation consists of that, that beings truly reflect that pleasure, which man can experience due to connection with beings. Man can give in to temptation and become dependent from beings of the hierarchies in determination of his free choice and in this sense to become unfree.

Each time when man gives in to temptation, in consciousness of manifested beings will be included a part of consciousness of man. The use of consciousness of man by beings is the reason why man is predisposed to become feeble-minded, physically underdeveloped and ill since his birth. Dependence from beings may be so strong, that it is necessary to pass through several incarnations before man can be freed. The purpose of incarnation of man in physical body is the development of consciousness. In order man could be incarnated in some form of physical body, this form must be manifested as relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. For this purpose various beings pass through various incarnations also. The Earth also has passed through various incarnations before man could have the present form of physical body.

Consciousness, life, form

The incarnations of man are connected with incarnations of the Earth which occur corresponding to rhythms of the development of consciousness of mankind. According to the rhythm of trinity there are three members in any manifested being, which are called *consciousness*, *life* and *form*. With the names *consciousness*, *life* and *form* it is always necessary to understand relations between the hierarchies of consciousness manifested through free choice of personalities. In this sense evolution of consciousness of mankind is unfolding of consciousness of personalities in infinite consciousness of Tao through principles of consciousness, life and form.

What mankind has become conscious of in the state of involution is manifested in the state of evolution, on the one hand, as the universal rhythms of the world structure, of the Macrocosm, and on the other hand as personal rhythms of Microcosm. The rhythm of trinity is the rhythm of the world structure and is manifested in any being as consciousness, life and form. With the form it is necessary to understand that, what allows a being to have finite consciousness, and thus separates life of one being from another. The principles of consciousness, life and form correspond to spirit, soul and body in man. Anther rhythm of the world structure is septenary rhythm which is manifested in the development of consciousness, life and form. How much consciousness, life and form of man

correspond to the universal rhythm, depends on his free choice. The interaction of free choice of personalities and rhythms of trinity, sevenness and so on, creates variety of manifestations of consciousness, life and form. Every man in present rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind is personality who has the ‘I’-consciousness, or is conscious of itself as the ‘I’. Not all personalities had such consciousness in the beginning of evolution and in this sense they could become man only in subsequent rhythms of the development of consciousness.

In order for man to have consciousness of himself as the ‘I’, his spirit, soul and body must be in certain relations to each other, that allow man to become conscious of his separation from his external environment. These relations between the hierarchies of consciousness were manifested through free choice of personalities which had the ‘I’-consciousness earlier, than man on the Earth. At what level of the hierarchies of consciousness each personality was manifested, it was determined by the first free choice of all personalities. Personalities which in the beginning of the evolution were manifested on the level of second hierarchy and higher, from the very beginning of the evolution had the ‘I’-consciousness. Other personalities did not have such ‘I’-consciousness yet and must pass through certain stages of the development of consciousness.

It is hardly possible to find out more detailed description of the stages of the development of consciousness corresponding to consciousness of modern man, than in books and lectures of Rudolf Steiner, which were written in the beginning of XX century. Because consciousness of mankind has changed since then, there is possibility to point out to the freedom of choice directly. Everywhere in works of Rudolf Steiner where it is possible to find the words about beings of the hierarchies staying behind, about sacrifice of beings of the hierarchies, it is always a talk about personalities staying on certain level of the hierarchies of consciousness, because to make sacrifices or to stay behind in the development of consciousness it is possible only then when one has the freedom of choice.

The Saturn state of consciousness

The first words in the Gospel of St. John "*In the beginning was the Word*" mean that "*In the beginning was the freedom of choice*", and specify that state of evolution when personalities on the level of consciousness of the hierarchy of the Beginnings developed their ‘I’-consciousness through free choice. This state of evolution in the kingdom of Lucifier is called the *Saturn state of consciousness*. It corresponds to the rhythm of All Might (omnipotence) which became conscious to mankind in the state of involution. This rhythm was manifested in each of three kingdoms differently. The manifestation of the rhythm of All Might in the kingdom of Lucifier is the Saturn state of consciousness.

In the Saturn state of consciousness Lucifier makes his free choice to remove limitations to manifest good and evil in his kingdom. In order to have the ‘I’-consciousness, it is necessary to become conscious of separation from all what is manifested. Therein there is also a possibility of manifestation of greatest evil. The greatest evil can be manifested through personality, which in consequence of its free choice will attain the highest consciousness of separation from mankind. In the Saturn state personality which is called *Satan*, *Mephistopheles* and *Ahriman* has used such possibility. Ahriman has manifested his ‘I’-consciousness as the highest principle of separation, possibility of which was provided by the free choice of Lucifier. Therefore it is said that Ahriman is Karma of Lucifier. In the Saturn state the principle of separation developed by Ahriman corresponded to the rhythm of All Might, that is why it was timely suitable and necessary for the development of the ‘I’-consciousness of personalities through free choice.

Because consciousness of Lucifier was the highest one, to know about his free choice it is only possible because he has made it accessible for supersensible perception. The same relates to the free choice of Ahriman to manifest the highest consciousness of separation. And the more it will be true for free choice of Christ. Lucifier, Christ and Ahriman make their free choice with objective of development of consciousness of other personalities. Their free choice is a sacrifice and they do not have intension to get any benefit from it or to hide it. The more it will be known about their free choice and those possibilities of manifestation which follow from it, the more other personalities can make their free choice consciously.

In the Saturn state of consciousness man had the lowest dull trance-consciousness, which comparable with consciousness of a stone or a mineral on the Earth. A being with trance-consciousness on the Earth is not conscious of itself as a being separated from its environment at all, but is conscious of itself only as a part of its environment. It perceives movements of planets, mineral forms, forms of crystals and so on, but plants, animals and man cannot be perceived by such a being. It is possible for it to perceive forms in the world structure, but not life of forms. Because personalities with trance-consciousness did not separate themselves from their environment yet, their free choice always corresponded to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Because the form of manifestation of a being depends on its level of consciousness, man in the Saturn state also had form and life other than modern man on the Earth.

In the Saturn state of consciousness man has such manifested physical body the development of which was influenced by free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Archai. Physical body of man had at that time quite different form, than it is now. All physical bodies of men were manifested as one physical body of the whole Saturn state of consciousness. The relations between the hierarchies of consciousness manifested as substance of physical body in the Saturn state of consciousness are called *Warmth*, or *Fire*. Manifestation of Warmth was connected mainly with free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Spirits of Will. Physical body of man that consisted of Warmth was changed under the influence of free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Archai.

The Sun state of consciousness

The rhythm of All Might was followed by the rhythm of All Wisdom which in the kingdom of Lucifier was manifested as the Sun state of consciousness. Not all personalities on the level of consciousness of Archai were able to develop the proper ‘I’-consciousness before the Sun state of consciousness has come to an end. Such personalities have stayed behind rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind in the development of their ‘I’-consciousness. The staying behind was not forced, but it was consequence of free choice of personalities. The rhythm of All Might continued to act in the Sun state of consciousness also, but it was not predominated any more. All previous rhythms always continue to act in following rhythms, but relations between them change due to free choice of personalities. Therefore, personalities which were not able to develop proper ‘I’-consciousness in previous rhythm, have possibility to continue the development in next rhythm, if it was allowed by new relations. In the Sun state of consciousness the ‘I’-consciousness developed personalities which were on the level of consciousness of the hierarchy of Archangel.

Personality which is known now as Jesus Christ was manifested on the level of consciousness of the hierarchy of Powers, or Spirits of Form in the Saturn state of consciousness. In the Sun state of consciousness Jesus Christ attains the highest ‘I’-consciousness among personalities with the level of consciousness of the hierarchy of Powers. The principle of separation developed by Ahriman is

manifested in the Sun state of consciousness as the principle that prevents the development of the 'I'-consciousness of Jesus Christ. Consciousness of Ahriman was still higher than consciousness of Jesus Christ and it influenced all personalities. The consequence of such influence of Ahriman was that in the Sun state of consciousness one personality which is called *Sorat*, or the *Sun-demon* has developed such consciousness which was opposed to consciousness of Jesus Christ.

In the Sun state of consciousness man had already dreamless sleep consciousness, which is comparable with consciousness of single plant on the Earth. A being with this consciousness on the Earth perceives life in minerals and plants, but the animal kingdom, feelings and thoughts do not exist for such consciousness. This state of consciousness is already less dull, but it is also less comprehensive, than the trance-consciousness. Free choice of man with dreamless sleep consciousness also corresponded to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind in the Sun state of consciousness.

In the Sun state of consciousness to the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness manifested as physical body of man, were added other relations which were manifested as the etheric body. The addition of substance of the etheric body has been connected mainly with free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Spirits of Wisdom. The etheric body supported more stable form of the physical body, than it was in the Saturn state of consciousness. The alterations of the etheric body of man were influenced by free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Archangel. The physical body of man becomes manifestation of the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which are called *Air.* Such relations made physical body still more stable to the alterations, taking place in the etheric body, owing to free choice of Archangels.

The Moon state of consciousness

The next rhythm All Love was manifested in the kingdom of Lucifier as the Moon state of consciousness. In this state the 'I'-consciousness developed personalities which were on the level of consciousness of the hierarchy of Angels. Among Spirits of Form in the Moon state of consciousness the highest 'I'-consciousness was attained by personality which is called *Jehova*, or *Jahve*. Jehova already has been manifested on the level of consciousness of the hierarchy of Powers, or Spirits of Form in the Saturn state of consciousness. However the leading personality among Spirits of Form Jehova becomes only in the Moon state of consciousness.

In the Moon state of consciousness for the first time was manifested that, what it is called the *fight in heaven* or the *war in heaven*. The war is always connected with violation of freedom of choice of personality. If one man wishes something that will contradict freedom of choice of other man this will wage war with other man. Though this war may not be manifested on physical level, however it is manifested on level of consciousness which is called mental and on which thoughts are real beings. Similarly, if man experiences feeling of hate or anger in relation to other man, then such war is manifested on level which is called astral where feelings, emotions, passions and lusts are real beings. For example, behind manufacture of arms there are always thoughts to kill. Therefore when men produce weapons they already wage war with other mankind on the mental level. If the feelings of benefit, greed, pride, envy, anger and similar are added to such thoughts, a war is waged not only on the mental, but also on the astral level of consciousness and it is not far away to its manifestation on the physical level at all.

The first war was waged on the level of consciousness of Angels which is higher than the level of waking consciousness of modern man on the Earth therefore this war is called the *war in heaven*.

Personalities on the level of consciousness of Archangels, Archai and higher made their free choice which could lead to mistakes, but it corresponded to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Therefore personalities on the level of consciousness higher than of Angels did not manifest evil. Their consciousness was high enough to make free choice, not violating the freedom of choice of other personalities. Personalities on the level of consciousness of Angels in the Moon state of consciousness for the first time began to make free choice depending on personal sympathies and antipathies which could contradict the freedom of choice of other personalities.

The free choice of Lucifier caused that some personalities could stay behind in their development because of free choice of other personalities. The free choice of personality is always manifested through beings of the hierarchies without freedom of choice. Therefore all hierarchies of consciousness have been involved in the war in heaven. Since then there were many wars and they will proceed to exist until it will be realized, that free choice of one personality must not violate free choice of other personalities.

In the Moon state of consciousness man had dreaming sleep consciousness, which is comparable with consciousness of single animal on the Earth. Such consciousness, besides the forms of mineral, plant and animal kingdoms, also perceives life and feelings of beings of these kingdoms. Such consciousness is still less comprehensive, than previous one, however free choice of personality with this consciousness still corresponded to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind.

To the physical and etheric body of man in the Moon state of consciousness were added relations between the hierarchies consciousness called *astral body.* The addition of substance of the astral body has been connected mainly with free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Spirits of Movement. Now free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Angels influenced the development of the astral body of man. The free choice of personalities of the level of Angels could, however, manifest evil already. Therefore personalities with consciousness higher than consciousness of Angels acquired wisdom to make free choice so, that on the one hand, do not violate free choice of personalities with consciousness of Angels, and on the other hand, to the greatest degree to protect physical, etheric and astral body of man from an influence of evil. Eventually man has received protection against evil in physical and etheric body because they gave in to the influences of the astral body less of all. The physical body of man in the Moon state of consciousness has been manifested as relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which are called *Water.* Because in the Moon state of consciousness personalities acquired wisdom to make free choice without violation of free choice of other personalities, the Moon state of consciousness is called the *Cosmos of Wisdom*.

The Earth state of consciousness

The rhythm of All Justice was manifested in the kingdom of Lucifier as the state of consciousness of mankind called *Earth*. Here the ‘I’-consciousness develop those personalities, which, actually, are called man and which still had no such possibility in the states of Saturn, Sun and Moon and. What is called the Earth planet is a plenty of relations between hierarchies of consciousness which allow man to develop his ‘I’-consciousness. The Earth planet is a characteristic of the whole Earth state of consciousness in a sense that on the Earth planet personalities can have the lowest and the highest ‘I’-consciousness in the world structure. The highest ‘I’-consciousness could be attained by Jesus Christ on the Earth planet.

When the Earth state of consciousness has come to existence, wisdom as result of free choice of personalities in the Moon state, was manifested in such relations between physical, etheric and astral

bodies of man which allowed him to develop the ‘I’-consciousness through his free choice. Such possibility of manifestation has been provided by free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of the Spirits of Form. Up to the Earth state of consciousness man had no waking self-consciousness of himself as of personality. Now the ‘I’-consciousness could be manifested in physical body of man. The relations between the hierarchies of consciousness manifested as physical body of man are called the *Earth*. In wonderful construction of physical body of man it is possible to see manifestation of wisdom which has been attained by personalities in the Moon state of consciousness.

Consciousness of single stone, plant and animal on the Earth could be manifested only because man had trance-consciousness, dreamless sleep consciousness and dreaming consciousness in Saturn, Sun and Moon states of consciousness. Therefore it would be mistake to imagine, that consciousness of single stone, plant, animal are exactly the same as there was consciousness of man. They were manifested due to free choice of man. Man, having these three kinds of consciousness, still had not separated himself from whole mankind and his free choice has always been agreed with free choice of other personalities. Only in the Earth state of consciousness man can make free choice which does not correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Man begins to use his free choice for the manifestation of good and evil.

Each of these states of consciousness in the kingdom of Lucifier is Manvantara when personalities create their Karma through free choice. The transition from one state of consciousness to another state of consciousness is carried out by personalities in state of Pralaya. In Pralaya personalities can experience the experiences of each other. For example, when personality lies, then the consequences of lie work destructive for consciousness of personality. In order to learn not to lie, it is not necessary for each personality to experience the consequences of its own lie it is enough to experience the experiences of other personality. Such possibility is provided in Pralaya to all personalities. Personalities do not create Karma in Pralaya, but process the results of free choice made in previous Manvantara and prepare to use them for the development of consciousness in following Manvantara.

The Earth state of consciousness icomprises the previous states of consciousness Saturn, Sun and Moon in itself. In this sense the previous states of consciousness were incarnations of the Earth being and had the mission to give man possibility to use forces of willing, feeling and thinking consciously.

According to four states of consciousness Saturn, Sun, Moon and Earth it is to distinguish four members or limbs in man: physical body, etheric body, astral body and the ‘I’. The development of the ‘I’-consciousness of man through mastering of willing, feeling and thinking corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind in the Earth state of consciousness. To bring these three elements through man consciously into balance makes up the mission of the Earth.

The seven kinds of consciousness of man

According to seven rhythms of the world structure, which mankind became conscious of in the state of involution, it is to distinguish seven states of consciousness in the kingdom of Lucifier. Seven kinds of consciousness, which man can have, correspond to seven states of consciousness in the world structure. To the four already described states Saturn, Sun, Moon and Earth will be added three more future states of consciousness Jupiter, Venus and Vulcan. All states of consciousness always exist together, beside each other and in each other, and became conscious to mankind as principles, in the state of involution. The involution and evolution of these principles is reflected in constitution of man. According to the seven states of consciousness there are seven members, limbs, or carriers of consciousness of man.

Trance-consciousness (Saturn, Physical body)
Dreamless consciousness (Sun, Etheric, life body)
Dreaming consciousness (Moon, Astral body)
Waking, day-consciousness (Earth, ‘I’ (Self))
Picture, imaginative consciousness (Jupiter, Self-Spirit, Manas)
Tone, inspirative consciousness (Venus, Life-Spirit, Buddhi)
Spiritual, intuitive consciousness (Vulcan, Spirit-Man, Atman)

Man is not limited only by these seven members. He is finite image of Tao, and enumeration of his seven members corresponds to septenary rhythm of the development of consciousness. There are other rhythms also, for example, nonary rhythm. According to nonary rhythm man consists of: *physical body, etheric body, astral body, sentient soul, rational or feeling (psychic) soul, consciousness soul, spirit-self or Manas, life-spirit or Budhi, spirit-man or Atma.*

The being of man is also described as consisting of four members or limbs: physical body, etheric body, astral body and the ‘I’. The fourth member - the ‘I’ (Self) - is the most complex member of all. It is individuality of man which contains all possibilities of development of the ‘I’-consciousness of personality. In modern man the ‘I’-consciousness comprise the sentient, rational and consciousness soul. It is expressed by that, that man can use feeling, thinking and willing consciously. The higher three members - Self-Spirit, Life-Spirit and Spirit-Man - will be developed in man when his astral, etheric and physical bodies will be completely under his conscious control. The rhythms for the development of higher members of man - Self-Spirit, Life-Spirit and Spirit-Man - will be manifested in future states of consciousness - Jupiter, Venus and Vulcan. This does not mean, man has no possibility to develop the higher members in the Earth state of consciousness. It means the development of the Earth has an objective of development of the ‘I’-consciousness of man through thinking, feeling and willing. When man will be capable to control consciously the processes of the astral body he will attain the development of Manas, or Self-Spirit. The consciousness in the etheruc body will signify the development of Buddhi, or Life-Spirit. Man becomes Atman, or Spirit-Man when the processes of physical body will be part of his waking ‘I’-consciousness. Man has these higher members in himself already, but he still cannot control them consciously.

The description of members of man is only a sketchy description out of which one should not make dogmas. Human being is much more complex, than it could be described at all. All hierarchies of consciousness participate in manifestation of human being and in order to describe it completely, it would be necessary to describe all possible relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. Therefore it is always possible to extend any description. For example, the astral aura of man in physical body has form of an oval, or an egg because the etheric, or life (vital) currents which permeate the astral body, form so-called etheric, or energetic cocoon which has shape of an oval, or an egg in man. It is necessary to understand the etheric, vital or energetic currents as relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which for the supersensible perception appear as streams or currents. All sentient living beings on the Earth have etheric cocoon which is connected with etheric body of the Earth. Death of being in physical body comes when its etheric cocoon will be destroyed. The etheric cocoon of man appears at the moment of physical conception and it keeps connection of the etheric body with physical body of man. When the etheric cocoon is destroyed, the etheric body is released from physical body and there comes alteration of consciousness called death. After death man can preserve his waking consciousness in the astral body if he has appropriate qualities, or attributes. The astral aura of man is a colour characteristic of qualities of man, laid on the etheric cocoon.

Life after death

During life in physical body man is not conscious of, that he is not only in physical, but also in the soul and spiritual world, among beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. In occultism the soul world is called astral world, and the spiritual world - *devachanic* world, or *Devachan*.

The expressions *sky, heavens, heavenly world* are used for a designation of the world of the heavenly hierarchies, whose consciousness is higher than consciousness of man. Because the hierarchies of consciousness are manifested together, beside each other and in each other, all worlds are manifested together too. Man is manifested in all worlds, but in waking consciousness in physical body he is conscious only of the world of physical space and time.

Perception of space is connected with perception of manifestation of the hierarchies of consciousness beside each other, and perception of time - with perception of rhythmic sequence of alteration of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. In this sense space and time exist until exists the manifested world structure and their perception depends on the level of consciousness of personality. Man in physical body is conscious of space of three dimensions, and of time - as a sequence of alterations in space. The soul and spiritual worlds are not physically spatial and timely worlds, therefore man in physical body is not conscious of them. His waking consciousness does penetrate through threshold of supersensible space and time. When man falls asleep, he crosses this threshold and loses that content of the waking consciousness which is adapted only for physical space and time. It can make clear why man, waking up, cannot recollect, what he perceives behind threshold of the supersensible world. Man crosses this threshold completely when his consciousness changes through death. The fear of death is connected with unconscious fear of sufferings which have to do with the loss of content of consciousness of physical space and time.

To adapt himself to the soul and spiritual worlds after death, man first must free himself from the connections with beings of the hierarchies which he has established, striving to satisfy lusts and desires through physical body. The state of consciousness in which man is purified from sensual lusts and desires of the physical world is called the *purgatory, Kamaloka* – the *'place of desires'* in Sanskrit. The deprivation of a possibility to get satisfaction of desire through physical body causes sufferings. The more consciousness of man, deprived of physical body, is connected with pleasures of the physical world, the more is suffering of purification. Kamaloka is not physical place, it is state of consciousness, Man is protected from direct perception of Kamaloka by physical body. To perceive the state of Kamaloka, it is not necessary to pass through death, it is sufficient to develop supersensible organs of perception during life in physical body.

Kamaloka is situated in the astral world, where lusts and desires of man are manifested through beings, which are called *Kama-devas*. In a similar way to how physical body of man has materiality, corporeality of devas also has some materiality. Materiality needs to be understood as such level of consciousness on which consciousness, life and form of beings of the hierarchies are manifested in equal proportions. The body of Kama-devas possesses astral materiality. The devachanic world, *Devachan*, is subdivided into low and higher areas. The low Devachan is the mental world where thoughts of man are manifested through beings called *Rupa-devas*. The higher Devachan is the world of intentions, ideas and plans. Here there are all possibilities of manifestation of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness through the free choice of personality. The beings of the higher Devachan are called *Arupa-devas*. According to the higher and low Devachan it is to distinguish in man the causal and mental body.

The causal body of man has originated in the beginning of evolution together with the first free choice of all personalities. Every personality has causal body which contains any choice that has already been made by personality. The made free choice is impossible to change, it is only possible to make next free choice. The made free choice is preserved unchanged from incarnation to incarnation and in this sense the causal body it is impossible to change too.

For example, to Kama-devas belong beings which in the Middle Ages have been still perceived as *gnomes*, *undines*, *sylphs*, *salamanders*. To Rupa-devas belong beings of third, and to Arupa-devas belong beings of first and second hierarchies of consciousness. In the spiritual world there is a level of consciousness which is called *Akasha-chronicle*. All results of free choice of personalities could be perceived on this level of consciousness. When one investigates Akasha-chronicle supersensibly, then it is possible to make conclusions about the free choice of personality only from the results of free choice. The free choice itself, as a cause, is imprinted in causal body of personality and cannot be investigated by others. The free choice is made through Tao and is an intimate act between personality and Tao. It can become known to others through Akasha-chronicle only with the consent of personality itself.

Everything is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness, therefore everything, what man perceives through his physical organs of perception, exist in other spaces as relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. After death instead of planets of the Solar system man perceives the hierarchies of consciousness and boundaries of their ruling realm. Man becomes conscious of himself in other spaces, when he is conscious of the hierarchies of consciousness. The space of Kamaloka, which is in the area of the Moon, will correspond to realm of the hierarchy of Angels. After state of Kamaloka man extends his life up to life of other planets of the Solar system. This corresponds to life in the realms of still higher hierarchies of consciousness. In the astral world in centre of activity of the hierarchies of consciousness is the Earth. The Sun is boundary of ruling realm of the Spirits of Form and is one of planets of the Solar system. In occultism the planet nearest to the Sun is called *Venus*, and the second from the Sun - *Mercury*. In natural science the names of the planets Mercury and Venus are interchanged. In the following table are present the planets of the Solar system and the corresponding boundaries of ruling realms of the hierarchies of consciousness.

Moon (Angels)
Mercury (Archangels)
Venus (Spirits of Personality, Archai)
Sun (Spirits of Form, Powers)
Mars (Spirits of Motion, Mights)
Jupiter (Spirits of Wisdom, Dominions)
Saturn (Spirits of Will, Thrones)

Modern man has his waking consciousness in physical body because owing to physical body he can become conscious of his own differentiation from his surroundings and to have the ‘I’-consciousness. After death of his physical body he loses part of waking consciousness already during purification in Kamaloka. On the one hand, he loses possibility to become conscious of himself because of lack of physical body, and in this sense his consciousness becomes more dull, and on the other hand, this allows him to extend his perception in the realm of Angels. To preserve his waking consciousness in the realm of Angels and in higher realms of the hierarchies of consciousness, man must possess properties, inherent to consciousness of beings of these realms. In a sense of exchange of consciousness these properties can be characterized by two words – *taking* and *giving*. Beings of the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice do not choose, how much to take and give. They can take and give only as much, as it is prescribed to them by rhythm of the development of consciousness of

mankind. As man has freedom of choice, these properties correspond to the qualities of *renouncement* and *sacrifice*. Both these qualities together is a characteristic of quality of love and of freedom from egoism. To preserve his waking consciousness, man must by himself counterbalance exchange of consciousness with beings of the hierarchies, making free choice how much to take and to give in a sense of setting connections with the hierarchies of consciousness. He must be able to refuse to take more, than it is necessary for the development of his consciousness and to be able to sacrifice his free choice for the sake of development of consciousness of other beings according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. And the higher are his qualities of renouncement and sacrifice, the longer he can preserve his waking consciousness after death. Independent of these qualities, his life and perception extend up to life of the hierarchies of consciousness.

Further extension of life of man after death leads him in the realms of Thrones, Seraphims and Cherubims. The human life extends up to the life of the Cosmos. Physically this corresponds to the area of twelve constellations surrounding seven planets of our Solar system. These constellations form so-called *animal circle*, or *zodiacal circle - Zodiac*. The names of signs of animal circle refer to connection of the hierarchies of consciousness with manifestation of human form and form of animals.

The physical form of man allows him to have the ‘I’-consciousness on the Earth. All hierarchies of consciousness which are manifested in it are manifested in configurations of stars, planets, animals, plants and minerals too. Physical form of modern man is only one of all possible forms in which man can have the ‘I’-consciousness. All possibilities of manifestation of such forms are in his individuality. In antiquity the connection of individuality with the form of manifestation of man on the Earth was designated in form of cosmic man inscribed in the animal circle - Zodiac. Each part of human form was drawn to the corresponding constellation of animal circle from which acted Thrones, Cherubims and Seraphims. Thus, one has giant cosmic man from whom every single man has got his physical form.

Head (♈Aries, Ram) - the sense for the ‘I’ of another person
Neck (♉Taurus, Bull) - the sense for apprehending thoughts
Arms (♊Gemini, Twins) - the sense for perceiving words
Breast (♋Cancer, Crab) - the sense of hearing
Heart (♌Leo, Lion) - the sense of warmth
Stomach (♍Virgo, Maiden) - the sense of sight
Pelvic gridle (♎Libra, Scales) - the sense of taste
Genitals (♏Scorpio, Scorpion, Eagle) - the sense of smell
Thighs (♐Sagiitarius, Archer) - the sense of balance
Knees (♑Capricon, Sea-Goat) - the sense of movement
Low legs (♒Aquarius, Water-Bearer, Man) - the sense of life
Feet (♓Pisces, Fish) - the sense of touch

Which form of manifestation modern man has, depends on his level of consciousness, and in the future, with the alteration of his consciousness, the form of his manifestation will change as well. In order man could have the form of physical body and to be conscious of physical space and time, interaction of all hierarchies of consciousness is necessary. The highest level of consciousness among the hierarchies, have Seraphims, Cherubims and Thrones. Above their consciousness there is level of consciousness of Trinity which is designated as the One, Two and Three and it is where plan of the development of the world structure comes from.

Man is born in physical body in the certain family, folk, country and during certain time epoch. He does not notice that his whole life is connected with life of the hierarchies of consciousness. His

personal life is connected with Angels, which are usually called the Guardian Angels. Life of whole folk depends on Archangels, and influences of Archai are manifested in peculiarity of the rhythm of time in which man is born on the Earth. In the state of consciousness after death man directly perceives the interaction of the hierarchies of consciousness. Instead of movement of the planets of Solar system he experiences the interaction of Spirits of Form, Spirits of Movement and Spirits of Wisdom. Life of the star systems, such as Solar system, appears to him as the manifestation of Spirits of Will, Spirits of Harmony and Spirits of Love. The highest consciousness of Trinity is manifested in life of the whole world structure.

When life of man after death extends up to life of the Trinity, then man has consciousness in causal body. In this state of consciousness man can perceive the free choice which has led to creation of Karma. Now he cannot change his Karma, because it has been created in other state of consciousness on the Earth. However he can make free choice which prepares new conditions for the correction of Karma on the Earth. His free choice leads to the changes in whole Cosmos, which are directed to the creation of such conditions. Man himself interacting with the hierarchies of consciousness prepares conditions for the birth and life in physical body on the Earth in correspondence with his Karma and rhythm of development of consciousness of mankind.

The purpose of incarnation of man in physical body on the Earth is the development of his ‘I’-consciousness. Besides already mentioned seven types of consciousness of man, there are other five stages which will be reached by man in future rhythms of the development of consciousness of mankind. The five others are creative stages of consciousness. They are those of the Creators, of the creative Gods. These twelve stages are related to the twelve signs of the Zodiac.

The stage of consciousness of the creative gods is the stage of consciousness of the heavenly hierarchies, and the higher is the level of consciousness of the hierarchies, the more powerful are beings of the hierarchies. Their power is manifested in the ability to give. Man learns to attain such power when he brings the ability to take in accordance with the ability to give. For this purpose it is necessary for him to pass through the school of life in physical body on the Earth.

The eighth sphere

The septenary rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind is manifested in every state of consciousness, life and form. This is reflected in seven members of man, which are manifested as relations between the hierarchies of consciousness owing to the free choice of personalities in the states of consciousness Saturn, Sun, Moon and Earth. In each of these states the development of consciousness goes through seven states called the states of life. The state of life is called *Round* in theosophy. Each state of life passes through seven states of form too. The state of form is called *Globe* in theosophy. Thus, personalities go through the development of 7*7*7 = 343 states of form. The number 777 *seven-seven-seven* is called the number of evolution and in this sense the number 444 *four-four-four* will be the number of present state of the evolution of Earth. Concerning the states of forms this number signifies the middle of the development of the Earth state of consciousness.

All rhythms of consciousness, life and form are manifested together. Therefore personalities which were not able to develop proper their ‘I’-consciousness in the previous states in time, have possibility to continue the development of consciousness in the following states. However as relations between the states of consciousness owing to free choice of personalities change, personalities not always can develop the ‘I’-consciousness by themselves. There could be manifested such relations between the consciousness of personalities and hierarchies that for the stayed behind personality it becomes

impossible to develop the ‘I’-consciousness, supported only by its own consciousness. The connection with beings, manifested due to free choice, does not allow the stayed behind personality to direct its own forces to the development of the ‘I’-consciousness.

This is one type of staying behind the development of consciousness of mankind. Personalities want to develop themselves, but cannot because of the connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. Such personalities become the bearers of evil by virtue of their separation from mankind through connection with beings. They can be helped by other personalities, whose consciousness is higher than the level of consciousness of beings with which the stayed behind personalities are connected. The other type of staying behind appears when personalities can change their connection with beings of the hierarchies, but do not want it to do. The stayed behind personalities become not only the bearer of evil, but evil itself. Such state of consciousness that will appear between the stayed behind personalities and beings of the hierarchies, is characterized by the number *six-six-six* 666. This means personalities can become evil itself when they will pass through the development of 6*6*6 = 216 states of form.

The following Jupiter state of consciousness will be the fifth of seven states. In the 6th state of consciousness, the Venus state of consciousness, in the 6th state of life and in the 6th state of form, when personalities will pass through the development of 216 states of forms, consciousness of the stayed behind personalities will develop such form of separation from mankind, that they become evil itself. This state of separation is called the *eighth sphere*, or *hell*, and the number 666 is called the *critical number* of evolution. In Apocalypse of St. John this number is referred to as the *number of animal*, or the *number of the beast*. The number *six-six-six* designates also Sorat. It is the name of personality which in the Sun state of the development of consciousness was the opponent of Jesus Christ. Sorat will be the leading personality of the eighth sphere.

Yin and yang

Modern man develops his ‘I’-consciousness in the fourth, the Earth state of consciousness, in the fourth state of life and in the fourth state of form. In each state of form are manifested seven more periods of time. The development of the ‘I’-consciousness of man takes place now in the fifth period which is called *Continental*. The first period is called *Polar*, the second – *Hyperborean*, the third – *Lemurian*, the fourth – *Atlantic*. The sixth and seventh periods are specified in the Apocalypse of St. John as the time of *opening of seals* (6:1-8:1) and of *soundings of trumpets* (8:2-11:15).

The periods of the 4-th state of consciousness, 4-th state of life, 4-th state of form are:

1. The Polar period
2. The Hyperborean period
3. The Lemurian period
4. The Atlantean period
5. The Continental period
6. The period of the opening of seals
7. The period of the sounding of trumpets

Each of these seven periods, is subdivided in its turn into seven other sub-periods during which the level of consciousness of mankind changes. Present time corresponds to fifth culture period which is called *European*. The first culture period is called *Pre-Indian*, the second – *Pre-Persian*, the third – *Egyptian-Chaldaic--Babylonian*, the fourth – *Greco-Latin* culture period.

The seven culture periods are characterized in the Apocalypse of St. John through *letters* (*messages*) to *communities* (*churches*) (2:1-3:22). The future sixth culture period is *Slavic*, and the seventh – *American* culture period.

The culture periods of the Continental period are:

1. The Pre-Indian, ancient Indian culture period
2. The Pre-Persian, ancient Persian culture period
3. The Assyrian-Babylonian-Chaldaic-Egyptian-Hebrew culture period
4. The Greco-Latin culture period
5. The European culture period
6. The Slavic culture period
7. The American culture period

In the Atlantean period of the development of the 'I'-consciousness man has realized the concept of Tao as a rhythm between the Heaven above and the Earth below and as the source of that rhythm. Such rhythm was characterized by two states of consciousness as yin and yang. In any rhythm there are always two alternating states as result of principle of duality. These two states can be considered as two opposites. Because there is nothing unconscious, rhythm can be defined as alternation or change of two states of consciousness. Yin and yang were representations of these two alternating states of consciousness and are not the abstract concepts of two opposites. That is why any rhythm can be considered as yin-yang rhythm of consciousness.

Everything is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness as beings in different states of consciousness, life and form. Yang corresponds to the state of consciousness, yin corresponds to the state of form, and to the state of life corresponds the rhythm between the states of consciousness and form.

The consciousness of the hierarchies without freedom of choice is always rhythmic, otherwise the hierarchies would have the freedom of choice. That is why a man making his free choice through the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice always involves yin-yang rhythms in the development of his 'I'-consciousness.

The period equal to 311040×10^9 years is supposed to be the rhythm of a being called Zodiac and should be considered as a number of yin-yang rhythms of consciousness.

The approximate time required for the Sun in its journey through the Zodiac is 25920 years. Thus, taking the Vernal Point of any given year, it will be further on the year following, and the year after will have progressed again. When 25920 years have gone by the Vernal Point will be back again at its original place. Thus 25920 years is an exceptionally important space of time in our Solar System; the sun has accomplished what might be called a cosmic step when at the vernal ascent it returns to the same point. Plato, the great Greek philosopher, called these 25920 years a cosmic year - the great Platonic Cosmic year.

If to divide 311040×10^9 by 25920 one gets 12×10^9 great cosmic years and the 12 corresponds to the number of Zodiac's signs. A human being draws 18 breaths a minute. In a day will be 18 breaths a minute, $18 \times 60 = 1080$ breaths an hour; in 24 hours, $24 \times 1080 = 25920$ breaths a day. A human being lives on the Earth, taking for simplicity, 72 years as the average length of human life, and 360 days in a

year. 72 years × 360 days = 25920 days in a man's life. So the human being lives as many days in his life as he draws breaths in one day. Human being has freedom of choice and is able to live more or less than 72 years, that depends on Karma and what rhythm he can choose to follow.

There is a periodical rhythm in the lunar eclipse, a rhythm of 18 years. That is just a quarter of a cosmic day of 72 years and just a quarter of a man's life. Man, as it were, endures four such periods of darkness. Why? Because in the world structure everything is in numerical harmony. On the average, Man has in accordance with the rhythmic activity of his heart, not only 72 years of life, but 72 pulse beats, and approximately 18 respirations - again the quarter - in the minute. Man is embedded in the hierarchies of consciousness in such a way that their rhythmic consciousness is reflected in man. The rhythm of four is due to the fourth embodyment of the Earth. That is why there are four seasons on the Earth, four phases of the Moon and the number of pulse beats is four times more than the number of breaths.

The Path

Modern man loses his waking consciousness during deep dreamless sleep. Initiation leads to the attainment of such waking consciousness which encompasses consciousness of deep dreamless sleep. Thus, initiation leads to the continuity of waking consciousness, and the continuity of waking consciousness means consciousness of the eternal life. The development of consciousness of man in usual life occurs through the development of qualities and faculties. However to become initiate consciously, it is necessary to know methods of the development of qualities and faculties, and to be able to use them properly. As everything is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness the qualities and faculties of personality depend on what relations will be manifested between personality and the hierarchies of consciousness through free choice of personality. Faculties are determined by how personality can use relations with the hierarchies of consciousness for manifestation of good and evil. How far personality applies faculties for manifestation of good only is determined by qualities, attributes or virtues of personality. Qualities allow personality to counterbalance relations with the hierarchies of consciousness manifested due to the free choice. To be able to manifest only good, it is necessary always to make such free choice that corresponds to the rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Otherwise instead of good will be manifested evil for evil is untimely the good.

The golden rule

The same faculty could be used for manifestation of good and evil. For example, the faculty of knowledge could be directed on satisfaction of lusts and well-being of all personalities. In order that the development of faculties did not lead to manifestation of evil, it is necessary to take care of the development of qualities. This constitutes the golden rule of the spiritual development:

For every single step that you try to take forwards in having knowledge of hidden truths, take three steps in perfecting your character toward the good.

Conscious development of qualities and faculties leads man to initiation. Consciousness of modern man allows him to pass through the path of initiation without having in his vicinity teacher in physical body, that is, such personality which already attained initiation. There is certain relation between the level of consciousness and qualities. Qualities attained by man on one level of consciousness remain

operative on any other level of consciousness. Qualities remain part of consciousness of man also when the rhythm of the development of consciousness is changed. Therefore qualities which were attained in physical body remain part of consciousness of man also after change of consciousness which occurs through death. It is impossible, however, to state the same about all faculties. Faculties to satisfy lusts through physical body are not preserved after death, though lusts remain. Qualities of initiate are natural laws which initiate steadily follows, irrespective of, whether he is incarnated in physical body, or not.

For there is a natural law for all initiates prompting them not to withhold from man knowledge that is due him. However there is an equally natural law which stating that nothing of esoteric knowledge can be imparted to anyone not called to have it. And the more perfect the initiate, the more strictly these two laws he observes.

The expression *natural law* does not mean that all initiates make an oath or sign a document to comply with some rules under the fear of punishment. It means that all initiates possess those qualities which allow them to have consciousness of initiate. And to be called to have knowledge or to have access to knowledge means neither more or less than to have qualities of such level of consciousness on which knowledge is used only for good. As any violation of freedom of choice of man is evil, then for initiate will be natural the following third law also:

Regulate each of your actions and each of your words so that free-will decision of any man will not be interfered through you.

As present rhythm of the development of consciousness allows each man to become an initiate then some conclusions follow from these laws. First, the path to initiation is opened to any man irrespective of, whether he strives through his free choice to manifest good or evil. Secondly, access to knowledge which man can attain on the path of initiation, depends not so much on his faculties, but rather on his qualities. And thirdly, knowledge attained on the path of initiation, must not violate freedom of choice of any personality. If the path of initiation leads to violation of free choice though one single personality, then this path is the path of black magic. Black magic is such use of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness with objective to achieve satisfaction of one’s own desires and lusts which violate the freedom of choice of man.

Man in physical body, perceiving the world of separate objects, is deprived of direct perception of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness and thus is protected from conscious connection with them. When man enters on the path of initiation, he becomes able not only to perceive beings consciously, but also to control them. Man appears in the unequal position in comparison with other personalities which cannot do this. There appears temptation to take advantage of such possibility for one’s own benefit. The qualities of initiate are guarantee that he will never use means of black magic for achievement of personal objectives. The use of faculties without appropriate development of qualities leads to black magic.

As there are possible various degrees of the development of qualities and supersensible faculties there are various degrees of initiation also. The more qualities of initiate are developed, the higher is level of his consciousness and the higher is degree of his initiation.

The word *teacher* will be used further on for the designation of initiate, who possesses qualities that can be characterized as one quality of freedom from egoism. This quality means that personality does

not identify itself with its own manifestation and develops the I-consciousness through free choice which corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. The quality of freedom from egoism is attained, beginning from sixth degree of the initiation, which is called the *Sun-Hero*. Initiate who reached such level of consciousness is free from earthly Karma and can develop his consciousness without incarnation in physical body on the Earth. If teacher makes free choice to be incarnated in physical body on the Earth, then he does this, following rhythm of the development of consciousness in which new possibilities must be manifested for the development of consciousness of man on the Earth. An example of teacher is Gautama Buddha. Teacher with the highest consciousness who was ever incarnated in physical body is Jesus Christ. Qualities which were developed by Jesus Christ are an ideal for any teacher, because they allowed Jesus Christ to attain the highest consciousness for personality in our world structure. Lucifer possessed the highest faculty of knowledge in the beginning of the evolution, but he had no sufficient qualities to use wisdom for unity of all beings. If Lucifer possessed sufficient qualities, then there would be no his Fall. The legend of Icarus also is confirmation that without developed qualities it is impossible to reach initiation. That Icarus learned to fly, means, that he possessed faculties. The fall of Icarus means, that for achievement of initiation of sixth degree it is not enough to have faculties only. The golden rule is valid on any level of consciousness.

In order to tread the path of initiation, it is enough to make free choice leading to the development of qualities. Long before man chooses the path of initiation, there is already teacher. It is expressed in the ancient saying: *When the pupil is ready, the teacher appears*. The level of consciousness of teacher is so high, that he is able to inspire disciple, not being incarnated in physical body. Thereby three laws mentioned are always complied with. Waking consciousness of modern man allows him to perceive only one event at once. Teacher is able to perceive several events together at once, and the higher is level of consciousness, the more events teacher is able to perceive at once. Teacher is able to inspire several disciples at once, irrespective of where and in what state of consciousness they are. Therefore teacher has many disciples, as a rule. Disciple going on the path of initiation sooner or later reaches such level of consciousness when he becomes able to perceive teacher. Up to this moment disciple could know nothing about his existence as well. Moreover, man could not know also, that he is already on the path of initiation for a long time. The path of life is already the path of initiation for everyone, whose way of life promotes the development of qualities. For the development of qualities no special conditions of life are necessary. The best conditions for the development of qualities are always those in which man is.

Physical body of man provides protection against direct perception of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, whose influences are manifested as lusts. The faculty of clairvoyance allows initiate to perceive these beings during lifetime in physical body and his qualities allow him to remain free from their influence. After change of consciousness which is called death every man loses protection of physical body and perception of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness becomes direct experience. If lusts were connected with pleasure received through physical body, then man after death experiences sufferings, to which no sufferings in physical body can be compared, because possibility of satisfaction is absent and lusts as relations with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness still remained. The level of consciousness on which man after death can experience sufferings from his own lusts, is called *Kamaloka* - place of desire, *purgatory.*

In Kamaloka man loses that waking consciousness which was limited by perception of the world of separate objects. Instead of the world of separate objects man can perceive in Kamaloka those connections with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which correspond to his sins. Sin or vice is

lack of qualities and is connected with lust. When satisfaction of lust passes into habit, connection with beings becomes sin. There are four basic kinds of sin: *pride, covetousness, envy, wrath*.

Sin is nothing else but relations of consciousness of man with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness manifested through satisfaction of lusts. As man after death has not physical body, then he perceives lusts in Kamaloka as real beings, which have forms reminding physical forms of animals. Consciousness of initiate permeates Kamaloka already during lifetime in physical body, not causing him sufferings because initiate possesses certain degree of the following seven virtues: j*ustice, abstinence from judgment, spiritual strength, cleverness, faith, hope, love.*

Manifestation of sin is possible on any level of consciousness. The Fall of Lucifer was caused by pride of his own wisdom. Lucifer had free choice to manifest only those possibilities of choice for personalities in his kingdom, the consequences of which he could himself to become conscious of. Instead of this, the choice was made, which allows personalities to choose from possibilities of rhythm of the development of consciousness directly irrespective of to what consequences this could lead. Thus, personality in the kingdom of Lucifer can manifest good und evil without limitations. As long as the manifested world structure exists, no personality can have perfect qualities. Even personality with the highest consciousness, Jesus Christ, whose qualities it is possible to consider as ideal for all personalities, has no perfect qualities also. There are no restrictions in the development of qualities for personality. Qualities allow personality to manifest good through free choice. However, as there are no restrictions for personality in the development of qualities and manifestation of good, there are no restrictions in the development of sin and manifestation of evil also. Therefore, when one speaks about virtues it is always meant certain degree of the development of qualities. As mankind is one unity, qualities of personality are characteristic of how far personality is conscious of itself to be united with other personalities. Sin is characteristic of how far consciousness of personality is separated from other personalities. As all qualities are connected with each other, because they all correspond to manifestation of good, it is not important, the development of which quality to begin from. The development of one quality leads to the development of other qualities as well.

Qualities and conditions of the occult training

The expression *occult training* should be understood as training which is not perceived by physical sense organs and in this sense it is hidden, or secret. Nothing is changed for man outwardly when he starts the development of qualities. The attainment of qualities creates conditions which are necessary for the development of supersensible faculties in occult training. As no personality can have perfect qualities, so nobody can satisfy conditions of the occult training perfectly. The chief thing, however, is that man would have perpetual striving for the development of qualities and thus is striving to fulfil conditions of the occult training. Let us consider connection of the development of qualities with conditions of the occult training.

Justice and health

The more man is conscious of himself as member of whole mankind, the more he is conscious of his connection with all personalities and the more he will manifest justice in relation to them. The quality of justice is opposite to the struggle for existence and man, possessing this quality, will not make choice without reckoning with other personalities. Therefore his choice will not assist strengthening of the war of all against all. Striving for satisfaction of the lust of benefit which leads to the war of all against all should not be mistaken for striving to be rich. To be rich in occult language means to possess qualities and faculties, which correspond to qualities. In this sense to be rich in physical life means to

possess qualities to attain all what is necessary for the development of consciousness in physical body according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. The fulfilling of duties in physical life promotes the development of the quality of justice and can be even harmful to personal health. Therefore the first condition of the occult training is health. This means, that man learns to undertake all what is possible for restoration and preservation of health, without refusing from fulfilling of his life duties.

Abstinence from judgement and membership in the whole of life

Any judgement based on personal sympathies and antipathies, means judgement from position of separation from other personalities. All personalities are connected among each other. The higher is consciousness of unity with all personalities, the less is urge to judge on basis of personal sympathies and antipathies. Personal judgement is never ultimately true, because, in order to judge truly it is necessary to have consciousness which encompasses consciousness of all personalities, what it is not possible in the manifested world structure. Ultimately true judgement it is possible only for all personalities together. What single personality can reach in life is never a merit of only one personality. Single personality always uses achievements of other personalities, quite often depriving them of favourable conditions for the development of consciousness. The second condition of occult training will be awareness of oneself as of integral member of mankind and by that as a member of the whole life.

Spiritual strength and reality of thoughts and feelings

Spiritual strength allows man to resist temptations to satisfy lusts. The opposite to strength is weakness which leads to lusts. Man constantly is exposed to temptations in his astral body what is expressed in striving for satisfaction of pleasures, for example, through excessive eating, drinking, sex, possessions and so on. Those who eat too much will manifest lusts in their astral body. All illnesses have their origin in lusts of the astral body. Therefore all religions prescribe purification from lusts through fasting. The concept of *fasting* should be understood, first of all, as refusal, abstinence from lusts. If man gives no food to physical body, then his physical body will weaken. In similar way, if do not feed lusts with thoughts, feelings, words and deeds, then lusts will be weaken also. However, if man do not takes in food and cherishes, for example, thoughts and feelings of satisfaction of sexual pleasures, then physical body will be destroyed very quickly. Therefore fasting means refusal to give food to lusts. That is why the quality of spiritual strength can be also called as quality of the refusal from lusts. Manifestation of strength and weakness begins with thoughts and feelings of man. Therefore the third condition of the occult training is to be conscious that thoughts and feelings are realities, and have not lesser importance, than words and deeds.

Cleverness and spiritual balance

As no single personality can possess perfect qualities there is always possibility to make a mistake through free choice. However the more the qualities are developed, the less probable is possibility of mistake, because personality makes its choice according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, instead of according to its own personal urges and objectives. How great the wisdom of one single personality could be, it can be only some part of wisdom of the whole mankind. The quality of cleverness is attained through experience of mistakes. Mistakes are possible on any level of consciousness, therefore manifestation of pride, greed, envy and anger are also possible on any level of consciousness. The quality of cleverness can be called quality of flexibility because it brings previous qualities to harmony and allows personality to become conscious creator of its own destiny.

Cleverness promotes fulfilling of fourth condition of the occult training which is called spiritual balance. This means balance between what is inside and outside. Consciousness of the true ‘I’ of man takes place inside human being, but the ‘I’ itself is not only inside, it is everywhere, and human being is part of the ‘I’. Cleverness allows keep balance between requirements of the outer world and inner development of qualities.

Faith and following taken decision

Clever, reasonable personality becomes so flexible in the development of its qualities that this allows it to develop quality of faith. The quality of faith means faith of perpetual development of consciousness through free choice which leads to knowledge of the internal infinite source of everything. How perfect an achievement may seem to be, it is only a stage in the development of consciousness of mankind. Any achievement will be always only some semblance of what could be attained. The quality of faith excludes dogmas which are created through personal understanding of religions and religious books. Any religion reflects only a stage on the path of the development of consciousness of mankind. With the changing of consciousness personal understanding of religions and religious books are changing also. Faith allows man to follow taken decision steadily if decision corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Following taken decision constitutes fifth condition of the occult training.

Hope and thankfulness

The quality of faith is connected with quality of hope of the development of consciousness through free choice. In what situation personality may be, there is always possibility for it of free choice which leads to knowledge of good. Therefore the sixth condition of the occult training is thankfulness to everything, what personality meets on its path of life. Free life of personality is gift of Tao and it is only possible owing to life of the whole world structure. Free choice of personality could be directed against other personalities, but without the development of its consciousness it is impossible the development of all other personalities, because mankind is one unity. Therefore there is no bad personality. Personality can become evil itself, but this will mean, that evil was necessary for the free development of consciousness of personality through knowledge of evil.

Love and unity of previous conditions

Love can be manifested only through free choice which leads to unity of all beings. If man makes free choice which leads to compassion, to sympathy, to participation, to unselfish assistance to others, then such free choice also leads to unity of personalities, and, consequently, to unity of all beings. Only personality, which has possibility of free choice to manifest good and evil without any compulsion can manifest love. And the mission of man as personality on the Earth planet is to learn to manifest love. Love must become natural power of man, his striving and his purpose, and could be understood as the power to give without expectation of any return. An example of manifestation of love was given by Jesus Christ. Similar as Jesus Christ was incarnated in physical body in order to help the development of consciousness of mankind on the Earth, personalities with the developed quality of love will be incarnated in the eighth sphere in order to help the development of consciousness of the stayed behind personalities, which became evil itself. Quality of love allows manifest all qualities as one whole. Therefore the seventh condition of the occult training is fulfilling of all previous conditions together.

There are certain relations between qualities, fulfilling of conditions of the occult training and seven members of man. As all members of man can exist and can be developed in harmony only through the

interrelations between each other, then the proper development of qualities and fulfilling of conditions of the occult training can take place only through the interrelations between each other.

1. Justice (Health, Physical body)
2. Abstinence from judgement (Membership in the whole of life, Etheric, life body)
3. Spiritual strength (Reality of thoughts and feelings, Astral body)
4. Cleverness (Spiritual balance, 'I' (Self))
5. Faith (Following the decision, Self-Spirit, Manas)
6. Hope (Thankfulness, Life-Spirit, Buddhi)
7. Love (Unity of conditions, Spirit-Man, Atman)

Quality of love is quality of sacrifice and giving because man gives his personal richness of qualities and faculties to the development of all beings. In the Gospel of St. Mathew (Matthew 19:16-24.) it is called to enter into the kingdom of heaven, following Jesus Christ.

And, behold, one came and said unto him, Good Master, what good thing shall I do, that I may have eternal life? And he said unto him, Why callest thou me good [perfect]? There is none good [perfect] but one, that is, God: but if thou wilt enter into life, keep the commandments. He saith unto him, Which? Jesus said, Thou shalt do no murder, Thou shalt not commit adultery, Thou shalt not steal, Thou shalt not bear false witness, Honour thy father and thy mother: and, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself. The young man saith unto him, All these things have I kept from my youth up: what lack I yet? Jesus said unto him, If thou wilt be perfect, go and sell that thou hast, and give to the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven: and come and follow me. But when the young man heard that saying, he went away sorrowful: for he had great possessions. Then said Jesus unto his disciples, Verily I say unto you, That a rich man shall hardly enter into the kingdom of heaven. And again I say unto you, It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.

Jesus Christ speaks first of all about the commandments which lead to eternal life. Man whose consciousness will be preserved after death of physical body will have eternal life. In these commandments it is contained much more, than could be noticed by superficial reading.

The commandment *do not murder* means do not cause harm or evil to nobody neither to oneself nor to anybody else. It is possible, when free choice of man corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. If man will learn not to do harm first of all to himself, having cleared himself from lusts, then he also will learn not to do harm to others. *To lust after* means to strive for pleasure just for sake of pleasure. Therefore the commandment *not to commit adultery* means *do not lust after,* and corresponds to continence in the satisfaction of lusts of the astral body. The commandment *do not steal* corresponds to quality of justice or to compliance with the law of Karma, because fair man is content with that, what it is allowed him to have by his Karma, and the law of Karma is justice. Man who lies, manifests astral beings which destroy his astral body, therefore lie is equivalent to murder on the astral level of consciousness. Father and mother in the commandment *honour thy father and thy mother* mean not only physical parents. As everything is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness, man is obliged by his existence first of all to the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. From this point of view, they also are father and mother of man in the manifested world structure. The respect for the hierarchies of consciousness is developed through comprehension of that, by what man is obliged by them in his life. Then consciousness of man becomes permeated first of all by feeling of thankfulness and he learns to use in his life only that, what is necessary for the development of his consciousness and consciousness of others. If man takes more

to himself, than he really needs, then he deprives others of possibility of the development of consciousness. Therefore the commandment *honour thy father and thy mother* will correspond to the commandment *do not be (live) excessive*.

The first five commandments correspond to five vows of Yama: *do not kill, do not lie, do not steal, do not be (live) excessive, do not lust after.* They were mentioned by Patanjali in his work *Yoga-sutras* as follows:

Non-killing, truthfulness, non-stealing, continence, and non-receiving, are called Yama.

Continence is interpreted usually as abstinence from waste of sexual energy, and *non-receiving* - as non-acceptance of gifts and non-accumulation of material possessions. If man wastes his sexual energy because of pleasure this means, that he has lust. If there will be no lust there will be no waste of sexual energy also. Therefore continence means, first of all, *do not lust after. Non-receiving* does not mean that it is necessary to refuse of use of gifts and material things. *Non-receiving* means that it is not necessary to take too much and corresponds to the vow *do not be (live) excessive*.

The correspondence between the commandments of Christianity and the vows of Yama originates from fact that in the life or etheric body of man there are five life currents. They become perceived by each man with certain level of consciousness. Sins, which are opposites to the vows of Yama, act on these life currents destructively. Through destruction of life currents, man kills life in himself. Jesus Christ and Patanjali specify five commandments because they are able to perceive ethetic currents and destructive action of sins on them. The expression *to enter into life* will mean *to enter into consciousness of the life body.* In order to become conscious in the life or etheric body, man must first of all comply with vows of Yama. They must become part of consciousness of man. From here it is possible to understand, why Yama is also god of death. For those one, who does not comply with specified commandments, kills life in oneself, gets in the power of god of death and, consequently must die.

The sixth commandment *love thy neighbour as thyself* specifies the fact that the development of consciousness of one man depends on the development of consciousness of others. In this commandment it is possible to notice the difference between teaching of yoga and Christianity. The vows of Yama are commandments of the achievement of perfection for single personality. The commandments of Christianity are commandments of the achievement of perfection for all together. The sixth commandment is connected with conceptions of *kingdom of heaven* and *kingdom of God* between which there is essential difference. The kingdom of heaven is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. Relations between the hierarchies of consciousness are manifested in rhythms of the development of consciousness of mankind, providing new possibilities of free choice of the development of consciousness to personality. In order that personality could enter into kingdom of heaven, it must make free choice, proceeding not from its own egoism, but from rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Personality becomes then similar to the hierarchies of consciousness. That is called to *enter into the kingdom of heaven*.

To become perfect and to enter into the *kingdom of God* means for personality not only to become similar to the hierarchies of consciousness, but also means to include in its own consciousness the consciousness of all hierarchies of consciousness and, thus, to know everything what is possible to know in the manifested world structure. However no personality can become perfect if there is even only one personality which still is not perfect. If though one personality is not perfect, then there is always free choice which is unknown to other personalities. This means that not all is known in the

manifested world structure. Therefore conception, that single personality, irrespective of other personalities, can become united with the absolute God, can merge with the Absolute or can attain consciousness of itself as Tao, is a mistake. To enter into the *kingdom of God* means the same, as to attain consciousness of itself as Tao. For this purpose it is not enough to develop one's own consciousness by the achievement of richness of qualities and faculties and to enter into the kingdom of heaven. It is necessary to direct the personal richness of qualities and faculties to the development of all. To enter into *kingdom of God* it is possible only for all personalities together when the richness of every personality becomes property of all.

The occult or secret training is always connected with the development of qualities. In ancient times to the occult training was admitted only those one who already had certain degree of corresponding qualities. As consciousness of man was less developed than it is now, then presence of teacher in the physical body was the necessary condition for the development of supersensible faculties.

The supersensible organs of perception

The development of supersensible faculties is based on the fact, that each time when man develops some virtue or quality, the new faculty of perception which corresponds to quality will be developed also. The development of qualities is connected with the development of astral organs of perception which are called *charkas, sacred wheels* or *lotus flowers*. Each man has these organs of perception, however, in order to perceive supersensibly in right manner, it is necessary not only to learn to use organs of perception, but it is necessary that they are properly developed. Skill to use chakras is a faculty. If one makes exercises for the development of chakras without appropriating development of qualities, then attained faculties of supersensible perception will be distorted, and man will fall prey to illusions, accepting what is desirable for real. This occurs because the faculties of perception will be developed through connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness from which man becomes dependent. As a rule, man becomes then immoral man striving for satisfaction of not apparently rough, but all the more refined lusts, and his health, both psychic and physical, will be destroyed. The proper development of chakras can occur owing to the development of qualities in every moment of life. For the development of qualities are not necessary neither special conditions, nor specially appointed time, those life conditions which there are now, are also the best.

In Indian writings it is possible to find various methods of the development of chakras. It is necessary to notice, that knowledge about chakras remained secret for a long time, by virtue of danger to get in dependence on beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. Such knowledge was passed over to disciple orally when his consciousness were enough developed. Only when common level of consciousness of mankind was changed, this knowledge could become accessible to every man.

Chakras are astral formations and they are situated in the astral body of man. This always must be considered, when position of chakras will be specified in the area of physical organs of man. Though chakras are single formations, they cannot exist by themselves, and represent one whole. Between chakras there is a plenty of connections, the main of them are called *spokes of sacred wheels* or *petals* of *lotus flower.* For independent development of chakras it is enough to have knowledge about petals of six lotuses. Knowledge about petals of seventh lotus can become actual only when all six chakras are already developed.

1. Muladhara (Base or Root Chakra, 4 petals)
2. Swadhisthana (Sacral Chakra, 6 petals)
3. Manipura (Solar Plexus Chakra, 10 petals)

4. Anahata (Heart Chakra, 12 petals)
5. Vishuddha (Throat Chakra, 16 petals)
6. Ajna (Brow or Third Eye Chakra, 2 petals)
7. Sahasrara (Crown Chakra)

The proper development of supersensible faculties is connected with purification and strengthening of certain connections between chakras. Lusts are astral formations which weaken and destroy connections between chakras what is manifested in various diseases. Therefore the proper development of chakras begins first of all with redirection of attention from satisfaction of lusts to the development of qualities. Qualities must become natural part of character of man. If man must make conscious efforts in order to live according to qualities, then this mean, that necessarily degree of the development of his qualities is not attained yet.

The development of qualities and faculties of man occurs through use of forces of thinking, feeling and willing. These forces of soul are interconnected between each other. When man wishes something he manifests feelings to wish and has thoughts about wish. Desire is manifested through free choice, and to make free choice means to manifest the will through Tao. In his day waking consciousness man, as a rule, does not become conscious of connections between these three forces of soul and can not control them consciously. The relations between them are regulated by the hierarchies of consciousness. If man will become conscious of connections between thinking, feeling and willing he will be conscious of the connections between the hierarchies of consciousness, through which these forces of soul are manifested. From here follows the necessity of the development of qualities which allow man to rule over thinking, feeling and willing. These qualities are connected, first of all, with the development of two-petalled, twelve-petalled and sixteen-petalled lotus flower.

Man develops the two-petalled lotus flower when he strives to become conscious of his thoughts, feelings and willing. The striving for conscious control is also that, what it is necessary for the development of this lotus. The development of the twelve-petalled and sixteen-petalled lotus flower has a feature that it is necessary to develop only half of the petals because other petals were developed in previous rhythms of the development of consciousness.

The development of the twelve-petalled lotus flower

For the proper development and use of the twelve-petalled lotus, it is necessary to develop the following six qualities:

1. Control of thoughts (Logical consistency of thoughts)
2. Control of actions (Initiative of actions)
3. Endurance, perseverance (Calmness, Equanimity)
4. Forbearance, tolerance (Positivity)
5. Impartiality toward everything that life brings (Faith or trust)
6. Inner balance, equanimity (Harmony)

Control and logical consistency of thoughts

Man gets control over thoughts when he is able to direct the power of thinking to one single object and to hold it on this object. Any object will be suitable and the simpler is the object, the better it will be. Thus the change of thoughts forms logical sequence which corresponds to object. Those outer and inner influences which can cause extraneous thoughts are excluded from consciousness so long until

man will not choose to allow them to be a part of his consciousness. The choice of man will remain logical and substantial even if it is influenced from outside by illogical and not concerning object thoughts. Thus all illogical what can reach his consciousness will be transformed into logical sequence. The power of thinking is accustomed to remain under control of man even then, when he begins to perceive beings of the supersensible world and this allows him to remain independent of their influence.

Control and initiative of actions

Man must learn to give similar direction to actions. All actions of man must begin from inner initiative, from conscious free choice. Any action will be brought under control of will. Subsequent actions become logical continuation of previous actions. Conscious ruling of man reaches all deeds both small and great. The will power must remain under control of man also when he meets beings of the supersensible world. Man must be able to follow strictly one's own will and not to be influenced by beings of the hierarchies. Lusts lose their influence on man and together with this the striving for satisfaction of lust ceases.

Endurance and equanimity

Endurance means that life of feelings is brought to harmony. Man keeps persistence and consistency in achievement of goals he has set himself. No obstacles divert him from goal as long as it is regarded to be the right goal. Obstacles become the requirement for him to overcome them. His feelings remain in harmony what allows him with equal equanimity to meet joy and sorrow, pleasure and unpleasure on his path to the goal. Man reaches certain degree of equanimity and calmness in life of feelings concerning pleasures and sufferings. He does not strive to suppress feelings, but he does not allow them completely to hold sway over his consciousness and degree of their outer manifestation is under his control.

Tolerance and positivity

Forbearance or tolerance towards people and beings allows man to find positivity in all things. Tolerance is connected also with understanding. Evil and good also can coexist because the freedom of choice exists. Evil is only untimely good and result of the manifestation of evil can be transformed into good. Therefore instead of condemnation man strives to understand and to reach positivity in judgements about phenomena of life.

Impartiality and faith

Impartial, unbiased man is ready to check up his opinion and view concerning the phenomena of life in every moment. He is always receptive to something new and does not allow the past to predetermine his judgement about new phenomenon in advance. If he has some opinion and corresponding intention, then he also has the power of faith in them. Power of faith allows him to remain opened for any new phenomenon and no obstacles and failures can deprive him of this power. Therefore impartiality means availability of faith.

Inner balance and harmony

Inner balance is attained through the harmonious development of previous qualities. Man keeps balance in any situation of life and do not allows neither the highest joy nor the deepest sorrow to

deprive him of his inner balance. He attains harmony in inner and outer life and gets ready for the occult training.

The development of the sixteen-petalled lotus flower

In order to develop the sixteen-petalled lotus flower it is necessary for man to develop consciously the half of the petals also. For this purpose man must attain certain degree of consciousness concerning *ideas and conceptions, decisions, words* (*speech*), *outer actions, arrangement of life, strivings in life, life experience, inner contemplative life*. This degree of consciousness corresponds to the properties of the eightfold path of Buddha which includes: *right opinion, right judgement, right word, right course of action, right place, right habits, right memory, right contemplation.*

Buddha was first man, who in physical body developed all these properties in himself.

It is once occurred that in one only man, namely in the personality of Gautama Buddha, all these qualities of the eight-fold path were thorough present. Thereby this personality gave the impulse, that now all men can appropriate these properties to themselves.

The objective of the eightfold path is deliverance of man from those connections with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which were established through lusts and desires in previous incarnations. Lusts and desires make man dependent on beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. This dependence is characterized by the word *Samskara*. Samskara does not cease to exist through death and it is kept from incarnation to incarnation in physical body. Lusts are rooted in the astral body of man. Therefore to be released from Samskara, man first of all must free his astral body from lusts. Deliverance from Samskara leads to deliverance from necessity of birth in physical body.

The eightfold path leads not only to deliverance from lusts, but also to deliverance from personal desires. Desire is always expressed through his free choice when man strives to attain something. When man would be free from personal desires? Only then when rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind is manifested in free choice of man. Qualities of the eightfold path allow man to become conscious of possibility to make free choice in which there is no personal desire to attain something. However before to start with the elimination of personal desires, it is necessary to become free from lusts. Otherwise an effort to restrain oneself from desires will to lead to disorder of health.

The degree of the development of qualities

The development of qualities must reach such degree, that they become natural part of character of man, become as one whole. The development of character of man begins with free choice which leads to the development of qualities. The consequences of free choice will be relations between the hierarchies of consciousness, manifestation of which will correspond to desirable qualities in man. Free choice must be repeated as long until manifestation of qualities becomes a habit.

In spiritual science one speaks of four attributes, which must be acquired on the so-called probation path, in order to ascend to the higher knowledge. The first of them is the faculty of discriminating in thoughts between what is true and mere opinion. The second attribute is the right estimation of what is true and real compared against the appearance. The third faculty consists in the exercising of the six attributes already mentioned previously: control of thought, control of actions, perseverance, tolerance, faith and equanimity. The fourth attribute is the love of inner freedom.

A mere intellectual understanding of what is included in these attributes is of no value. They must be so incorporated into the soul that they establish the inner habits.

All transient outer phenomena which man perceives through physical sense organs are manifestations of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. Behind these relations there are beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. Fruit and plant which grows from fruit are various manifestations of the hierarchies of consciousness. The hierarchies of consciousness are that true what remains, when the form of phenomena changes. That what is true always exists in basis of the transient phenomenon that is why it is more valuable than phenomenon itself. However that, what is transient, exists for that, what is eternal, and evolution is possible because of existence of that, what is transient. Acting through that, what is transient, man acquires qualities which allow him to have consciousness of that, what is eternal. In order that man could attain inner freedom, it is necessary, that his free choice corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Love to inner freedom is love to what is eternal. Eternal, imperishable in man is Tao. Man attaining all the higher levels of the hierarchies of consciousness can reach consciousness of himself as Tao only gradually.

Man who does not strive particularly for the development of supersensible faculties or has no time to develop them, always has possibility of conscious development of qualities in everyday life. Life in physical body is the best school for the development of qualities. It always provides possibility of choice for the development of qualities through use of forces of thinking, feeling and willing. Those one, who through life in physical body develops one's own qualities, will have supersensible organs of perception in correspondence with rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind.

Qualities of Zodiac

1. Aries ♈ Devotion (reverence) transforms into the power of sacrifice
2. Taurus ♉ Equilibrim (inner balance) transforms into progress
3. Gemini ♊ Perseverance (endurance, steadfastness) transforms into faithfulness
4. Cancer ♋ Unselfishness transforms into catharsis
5. Leo ♌ Compassion transforms into freedom
6. Virgo ♍ Courtesy transforms into tact of the heart
7. Libra ♎ Contentment transforms into serenity
8. Scorpio ♏ Patience transforms into insight
9. Sagittarius ♐ Control of speech transforms into a sense of truth
10. Capricorn ♑ Courage transforms into the power of redemption
11. Aquarius ♒ Discretion (reticence) transforms into the power of meditation
12. Pisces ♓ Magnanimity transforms into love

Man, who wishes to acquire supersensible faculties still during life in physical body, must develop them through exercises in concentration and meditation. Concentration is to understand here as the directing of attention to certain ideas and concepts which are connected with well-known relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. Meditation is such grasping of feelings, concepts, ideas, thoughts which leads to consciousness of their essence.

Imagination, inspiration, intuition

Three types of meditation: imagination, inspiration and intuition are most suitable for modern man. As all is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness, then concepts of three types of meditation can be specified as follows. Imagination is meditation which leads to consciousness of

single beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. Meditation which leads to consciousness of relations between beings of the hierarchies of consciousness is inspiration. Intuition is meditation which leads to consciousness of essence of the hierarchies of consciousness. Through intuition man becomes conscious of that, what beings of the hierarchies of consciousness are conscious of and thus he includes consciousness of beings in his consciousness. The exercises in imagination, inspiration and intuition develop use of forces of thinking, feeling and willing. The development of qualities allow to regulate their use so, that man becomes master of three forces of soul, uses them in full consciousness and remains independent from single beings of the hierarchies of consciousness.

Man has possibility to develop faculties and qualities in physical body, and thus he is protected by physical body from direct perception of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. If man consciously developed qualities in himself, then they remain his property also when he starts to perceive beings of the hierarchies of consciousness directly. Qualities allow him to remain independent of their influences. Man who begins the occult training without sufficient development of qualities, risks to get into dependence on beings, without the slightest idea about such dependence. Only faculties cannot guarantee safety of his freedom.

Here is an example of symbolic images.

From the geometry of Euclid it is known, that the sum of three angles of any triangle is always equal to two right angles. Triangle cannot be drawn or seen by physical eyes because it is impossible to draw or to see with physical eyes line, for line is length without breadth. It is possible to draw an image of triangle however this is not triangle itself. This will be symbolic image which depicts relations between those beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which cannot be seen by physical eyes. Such image of triangle can be evoked mentally in consciousness. If to change angles or sides of triangle mentally, the sum of angles of triangle is kept the same. Then it is possible to imagine equilateral triangle as general image of all possible triangles. It is possible to attach to it feeling of balance and harmony which originates from keeping in consciousness of such image. This will be imagination. Then it is possible to remove image from consciousness and to be aware only of that pure activity of soul which creates such image. This pure activity of soul is connected with relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which are expressed in image of triangle. This will be inspiration. If to keep in consciousness that, what remains after removal of this pure activity of soul, then in consciousness of man will be revealed consciousness of beings of the hierarchies to which corresponds image of triangle. Man has then in consciousness thinking without thoughts generated by pure activity of soul. This will be intuition.

Through intuition it is possible to find out connection of image of equilateral triangle with the mission of the Earth which can be fulfilled by man through establishment of balance between the forces of willing, feeling and thinking.

In occult symbolism this mission of Earth has always been expressed in a special way by means of a geometrical figure. Amongst geometrical figures you will find none which corresponds to cooperation in a sense of balance so exactly as the equilateral triangle. If you draw an equilateral triangle you will find the three sides are equal, the three angles equal, the vertices are equidistant from each other and all are equidistant from the center. The center of an equilateral triangle is an absolute symbol of activity of balance, so that when the occultist beholds an equilateral triangle he can see in it a symbol of the absolutely balanced cooperation of that, what had the hegemony in three former incarnations of our Earth respectively. The deeds of the 'I' in man signify nothing else but the creation of an operative, an active center in nature of man whereby this state of balance can be prepared from within outwards. Man indeed is called to high destiny on our Earth namely to bring about from within outwards, through

his whole being, first of all a balance between that what was predominant respectively in various ways and at various times.

The hierarchies of consciousness which are not perceived by physical sense organs constitute the so-called occult writing which could be learned to read and understand. Through imagination man learns to perceive beings of the hierarchies of consciousness in symbolic images. Symbolic images are thereby letters of the occult writing. Inspiration allows man to know the relations between beings of the hierarchies of consciousness and thus to read and understand the occult writing. Intuition allows man himself to have consciousness of the hierarchies of consciousness.

An attainment of the higher level of consciousness in comparison with previous levels always means, that what was carried out by the hierarchies of consciousness on the previous level of consciousness, now man must carry out by himself. In the Vulcan state of consciousness the level of consciousness of man will be so high, that he will be able to form consciously his own kind through himself. Personalities, which stayed behind in the development of consciousness, will be able to develop their consciousness owing to the sacrifice of other personalities. Owing to the faculty to produce his own kind through himself man will provide possibility for personalities in the eighth sphere to be incarnated on the higher level of consciousness. Personalities with high developed consciousness will make free choice to connect the development of their consciousness with the development of consciousness of personalities of the eighth sphere.

The Guardian of the Threshold

Mastering of forces of thinking, feeling and willing makes man able to regulate connections between these forces of soul consciously. If previously the hierarchies of consciousness must provide harmony between them, then on certain level of consciousness man himself must regulate the relations between thinking, feeling and willing. Such level of consciousness man attains through the development of qualities and exercises in imagination, inspiration and intuition. This causes certain changes in relations between consciousness of man and hierarchies of consciousness. The consequences of these changes are that in the etheric body of man are formed three centres of consciousness: in the area of head, throat and heart. These centres of consciousness together with chakras allow man to have consciousness outside physical body. Thus, man reaches the threshold between sensible-physical world and supersensible world. The proper achievement of this threshold is connected with experiences which are called the *encounter with lesser and greater Guardian* of the threshold.

Before man as a disciple is led to that point at which he can work on his etheric body at will, he must at least, to a certain extent be able to evaluate Karma, be able to achieve self-knowledge. Meditation therefore should not be undertaken without continual self-knowledge, self-observation. By this means will be achieved that at the right moment man will behold the Guardian of the Threshold: the Karma which he has still to wear away. When one reaches this stage being in normal state it merely means nothing else but knowledge of his still available Karma. If I begin to work into my etheric body, I must make it my aim to compensate my still existing Karma.

The lesser Guardian of the threshold is a real being in which the Karma of man is reflected and in which thoughts, feelings and desires are manifested, that do not correspond to rhythms of the development of consciousness of mankind. This is the astral double of man which possesses consciousness and can influence free choice of man. In the astral double are reflected all those connections of man with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which correspond to his vices. Perception of the lesser Guard of the threshold allows man for the first time to know himself as such as

he has made of himself through his free choice. If man attained sufficient degree of the development of qualities in order to pass over to the higher level of consciousness, then from now on he must transform his astral double by himself consciously. If previously the hierarchies of consciousness provided protection against influence of the astral double, then now man must do it himself through control of thinking, feeling and willing. Man endangers to come under influence of the astral double and become dependent on vices which he himself manifested.

If man concedes to influence of the astral double, then his astral consciousness becomes deformed and free choice of man will be influenced from now on by his astral double. If qualities of man are developed high enough and he is able to regulate himself the connections between thinking, feeling and willing, then man has possibility to become conscious of that ideal to which he can direct the development of his consciousness. This is the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold. Thoughts, feelings, willing of man on this level of consciousness are real beings, and his further path depends on his free choice weather to strive or not to the attainment of consciousness of the greater Guardian of the threshold. It appears to man as an ideal of consciousness which can be attained if man will follow rhythms of the development of consciousness of mankind. In this ideal are reflected those qualities of Jesus Christ which allowed him to attain the highest consciousness among personalities in the manifested world structure. Thus, the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold is the encounter with the Christ.

Man has then free choice to follow the Christ-principle - the principle of union of all personalities. If he chooses not to follow it, then further path of the development of consciousness of man can become even more egoistic, than it was till now. On this path it is possible to find satisfaction of the greatest egoism therefore this path is called the *black path*. Man who has chosen the black path will stay behind rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind in the future. It is absolutely not obviously that man will choose to follow the principle of Christ. Through the astral double man becomes accessible to the temptations of satisfaction of personal egoism which are immeasurably exceeded those, which man can encounter in physical body. Before the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold man was engaged in the self-perfection. He could develop qualities and faculties and improve his Karma irrespective of what qualities and faculties could develop other personalities. To follow the Christ-principle means to direct all richness of personal qualities and faculties on rendering the assistance in perfection of other personalities. The consequence of following the Christ-principle will be the development of consciousness of personality according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind.

Jesus Christ is integral part of reality. If there is real personality it is possible to become conscious of its existence, to perceive it and, consequently, to encounter with it. Christ cannot be seen with the physical eyes however it is possible to perceive him with supersensible organs of perception. Any system of self-perfection which leads to knowledge of the supersensible reality, will lead to perception of the reality of Jesus Christ also. Any system of self-perfection which leads to proper development of qualities and faculties of man, will also lead to the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold. To pass the greater Guardian of the threshold will mean to attain consciousness of freedom from egoism.

One of the most ancient systems of the development of consciousness is yoga. It existed already during the first old Indian culture period. During this period of the development of consciousness of mankind, the relations between physical, etheric and astral bodies of man were different, than they are now. Therefore the system of yoga which Patanjali described in *Yoga-Sutras* differs from yoga of the first old Indian culture period. Patanjali expounded the stages of the yoga system in such a way that

they become suitable to changed consciousness of man. In *Yoga-Sutras* are described eight stages of yoga:

Yama, Niyama, Asana, Pranayama, Pratyahara, Dharana, Dhyana, Samadhi are the limbs of Yoga.

Why the yoga system is stated in eight stages, it is possible to understand if to consider, that the development of consciousness of mankind goes through the seven states of consciousness: Saturn, Sun, Moon, Earth, Jupiter, Venus, Vulcan. These states of consciousness correspond to the seven stages of yoga. The eighth stage of yoga is connected with that, that the personalities which have stayed behind in the development of consciousness will form the eighth sphere. In order that the personality could attain the self-perfection, it must attain consciousness of itself as of Tao. However to attain consciousness of oneself as of Tao can only all personalities together. Until there exists the eighth sphere, no personality can reach perfection. The eighth sphere must be transformed into the sphere of perfection. This state of transformation corresponds to the eighth stage of yoga, that unites the previous seven. Thus, in the stages of yoga are contained the preconditions for the achievement of perfection of all personalities together. The highest consciousness of this perfection has Jesus Christ. Therefore the proper development of consciousness according the yoga system will lead also to the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold.

During the first old Indian culture period the personality of Christ was known as the Vishva-Karman. In order to perceive Christ during this period man had to be free from the terrestrial Karma and develop his consciousness outside the physical body. In the physical body man who perfected himself through yoga, could perceive with his consciousness other personality which is called Krishna. Consciousness of Krishna is that highest consciousness which man can attain if he will be engaged in self-perfection through the establishment of harmony between the manifestations of three Gunas: Sattva, Rajas and Tamas. Modern man is so connected with luciferic and ahrimanic beings, that he is not capable any more to reach this harmony by himself. After the incarnation of Christ, man in the physical body can reach this harmony of Gunas, if he follows the principle of love manifested through Christ. Only through the help of Christ he can reach the harmony of Gunas. The encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold becomes the necessity for man striving for the perfection through the yoga.

To understand that, what is meant in yoga system and to know the consequences of the exercises of yoga can only that man who already possesses the certain level of consciousness and faculties of supersensible perception. Therefore for safe development of consciousness by means of the eight stages of yoga it is necessary the presence of the Guru - the teacher in the physical body. Without such Guru the exercises according to the yoga system of Patanjali will lead to the infringements of health. To follow the yoga system of Patanjali there are necessary the direct communication with the Guru and special conditions of life. Therefore independently to follow the yoga system of Patanjali to the modern man it is possible only in exceptional cases.

The Buddhism is another system of self-perfection in which also is provided the possibility of the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold. It is possible to find the following words in the text of Dhammapada:

Do not what is evil. Do what is good. Keep your mind pure. This is the teaching of Buddha.

The free choice of man manifests the good or evil, depending on the conformity to the rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. When the mind of man is pure, then man is free from lusts

and can know intuitively. The pure mind allows man to perceive the rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind and to make the free choice according to it. As Jesus Christ is the personality with the highest consciousness, then his free choice most of all corresponds to the rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Therefore man with pure mind is able to become conscious of the greater Guardian of the threshold.

Man who properly develops the qualities and faculties of the eightfold path attains consciousness of Buddha. The consciousness of Buddha is consciousness of love and compassion which is free from egoism and the highest consciousness of love and compassion among all personalities has Jesus Christ. Therefore if the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold does not occur, then that means that qualities of man are insufficiently developed to attain consciousness of freedom from egoism.

Man may not have the supersensible faculties at all and reach the freedom from egoism during life in the physical body. It is not well known fact, that Mother Teresa (Agnese Gonxhe Bojaxhiu), having passed through the death, has also passed the greater Guardian of the threshold and reached the level of the teacher. She could follow the Christ-impulse during the life in the physical body. To follow the Christ-impulse means, that man leads the life so, that it corresponds to the development of quality of the freedom from egoism and to the consciousness of unity of all people. If to consider the supersensible faculties, which has Gautama Buddha in the physical body, then it is possible to find out, that Mother Teresa had not them. However, if to compare their qualities, it is possible to find them equal, because they were enough to reach the level of the teacher. The way of the development of qualities was different. Gautama Buddha developed the qualities the eightfold path in the solitude through the meditation and contemplation. The development of qualities of Mother Teresa occurred through the help to other people in their everyday life. Both, however, have developed the quality of love and reached the freedom from egoism. Both can be called saint because the concept of saint means that man has the quality of the freedom from egoism. In general, everyone who has reached consciousness of the freedom from egoism, it is necessary to call saint. As concerns the supersensible faculties, then to develop them for man who possesses the qualities, does not makes the great difficulty. Between the births of Gautama Buddha and Mother Teresa in the physical body has passed about 2500 years. During this time interval the qualities of Buddha have received the further development, and he has reached the level of consciousness which exceeds the level of consciousness of Mother Teresa. But if to compare the qualities which Gautama Buddha and Mother Teresa have at the end of their life in the physical body, then their qualities corresponded to the qualities of consciousness of the freedom from egoism. Thus, to have the supersensible faculties is not necessary to attain the new level of consciousness.

The life in physical body always provides the possibilities of the development of qualities of the freedom from egoism. In this sense the best path to the unity of mankind and thus the best way to Tao is the developing of the qualities in everyday life.

The Science and Reality

Consciousness of human being has one property, without which no concept and no judgment are possible about the reality. This property allows man to become conscious of any set of objects or elements, as one uniform whole, as one unity. From here originates possibility to designate one uniform whole which is coming to consciousness, by words and symbols. For example, single object it is possible to call "one" and to denote it by symbol "1", several objects to call "en" and denote them by

symbol "N", and so on. On the one hand, this leads to the concept of number and lays the basis for the natural science. On the other hand, this leads to the concept of reality which is all. Because two "all" cannot exist, such reality must be only one. Irrespective of which name to give this reality, it must has consciousness. If the reality which is all, would not have consciousness, then man as a part of "all", also would not have any consciousness. The concept of reality which has consciousness leads to the theses of Tao as the science of one unified reality.

If in the natural science to accept the assumption, that the laws of nature are an outer expression of internal relations between the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice, then the natural science can be extended to the spiritual science. These relations are expressed in the natural science as relations between numbers. Number is the concept which cannot be seen with physical eyes. It is possible to see an outer designation, a symbol of number, but number itself it is not possible to see. In a similar way, beings of the hierarchies of consciousness cannot be seen with physical eyes, it is possible to see the world of single objects as an external manifestation of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. However just because everything is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness, it is possible by means of invisible concept of number to make judgements about visible reality. Take, for example, the natural numbers. The concept of natural number means, that if there exists the number N, then there exists the greater number N + 1 as well. From here there appears the concept about the infinity of the natural numbers. As the manifested world structure is finite then everything, what can be manifested in the world structure, including any concept and its application, will be finite also. In the world structure which has a beginning and an end, it is impossible to apply the concept of natural number N, in order to form the greater number N + 1 infinitely. Therefore the concept of infinity of the natural numbers does not correspond to the reality. There is only one infinity which is all. What is not all is finite and is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness. The concept of any number and its application are manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness also.

Any concept, as relations between consciousness of man and the hierarchies of the consciousness, which were created through free choice, will become an illusion when concept does not correspond to the rhythms of the developing of consciousness of mankind and consequently to the reality. Thus the concept of the infinity of numbers is an illusion which does not correspond to the reality.

So-called laws of nature are manifestations of the first hierarchy, while forces of nature are manifestations of the third hierarchy of consciousness without freedom of choice. Individual animals and their group souls are manifestations of the second hierarchy of consciousness.

The hypothesis regarding the existence of hierarchies of consciousness can always be confirmed through supersensible perception and verified by experiment and logical reasoning. Since all concepts exist within the consciousness of the one reality - which is infinite and encompasses everything - it is impossible to define that reality using finite concepts.

Concepts based on notions that deny the presence of consciousness in all things naturally cannot correspond to reality - as is the case, for instance, with the law of gravity.

The Cavendish-Experiment



It is not difficult to verify that the true cause of the rotation of torsion balance in Cavendish experiment is not gravitational force between masses, but the interaction of two pairs of masses. It is amazing that this cause was not properly investigated.

If to place on one line the small equal masses (m) of torsion balance symmetrically between the suspended big equal masses (M), then the rotation of torsion balance will take place anticlockwise viewing from top. The rotation will depend on symmetry, an intersection between two lines connecting two pairs of masses, the masses and distances between them. Other combinations where masses are placed on one line can cause rotation also.

There will be no rotation if only one suspended big mass of any weight is used. The insertion of the second big mass will cause rotation again.

The procedure is simple:

1. Place two big equal masses in proper positions and let oscillating stop.
2. Remove one big mass and let oscillating stop.
3. Remove second big mass and let oscillating stop.

The symmetry and equal (identical) masses are important for the rotation of torsion balance. Even the standard torsion balance with the swivel support can be used to prove this. In such a case the symmetric swivel support must be set perpendicular to the bob arm of torsion balance and stay without masses during an experiment. To achieve the best results the swivel support must be removed and only two suspended pairs of masses are used.

The calculations can be correct but their interpretations wrong. Even though the Cavendish experiment allows make calculations of so called gravitational constant, it disproves an existence of gravitation between any two masses. However it proves that certain combinations of masses can cause the motion of masses. Such combinations of objects where two identical objects define the behavior of a symmetrical system of objects are also not difficult to find in the phenomena of electricity and magnetism.

The Earth

Kepler in The Harmony of the World (Harminices Mundi) describes the Earth as an animated being. To be alive means to have consciousness. The Earth does not attracts objects as unconscious mass, but it acts consciously like man would act when he puts consciously his arm on his forehead. The Earth has consciousness that could be perceived in the rhythmic processes of the Earth. It was announced that the gravitational waves had been registered. What was registered however is a rhythmic process that has period of 36-38 years.

The life of man in physical body depends on life of the Earth. It is not difficult to notice, that man who returns back to the Earth after visiting the space station, becomes weak, cannot walk without assistance and needs help. A pilot of a jet plane who can experience the same or even much bigger overstress but at much smaller distance from the surface of the Earth does not need such help and is able to walk without assistance immediately after landing. Therefore essential is not the overstress caused by flight but the connection of man to the Earth. It is possible to verify that connection of man to the Earth is

inversely related to the distance from the Earth. The distance from the Earth where man in physical body cannot be alive is between seven and twelve radiuses of the Earth.

There is a general concept that if man can exist in the diving suit under water on the Earth and in the spacesuit at some distance from the Earth it is also possible for man to exist at any distance from the Earth, e.g. on the Moon. Thereby it is ignored, that if one dives under water, one stays on the Earth and preserves the connection to the Earth, and if one moves far enough away from the Earth, one loses the connection to the Earth. All so-called proofs, that man in physical body was on the Moon, can be created without presence of man on the Moon. To reach the distance from the Earth that is less than distance between the Earth and the Moon and which is between seven and twelve radiuses of the Earth would be lethal for man. It is approximately where the geostationary orbit begins.

The life of man depends on the life of the Earth in such a degree that man in physical body became an inseparable part of the Earth. This means that man in physical body cannot exist without the Earth. The manned spacecraft or spacecraft with higher animals aboard should try to reach the distance from the Earth which is between seven and twelve radiuses of the Earth. It is necessarily to carry out such experiment in order to eliminate wrong concepts of existence and reality.

The idea of gravitation

It is not possible to explain the interaction of two pairs of masses in Cavendish experiment using an idea of universal gravitation, because this idea does not correspond to the reality. Before conclusions about an existence of gravitation can be drawn, one must try to distinguish to what extent the observed phenomenon is separated from other phenomena and to what extent it forms a part of the whole. In such a way the Solar system must be considered as a whole and the planets as inseparable parts of the Solar system.

It is well known that the Newton's law of gravitation was derived from the Kepler's law for the planets of the Solar system. Such derivation and calculation is possible because the Kepler's law contains the Newton's law without masses. The Kepler's law states that the squares of the orbital periods of the planets are proportional to the cubes of the semi-major axles of their orbits (1).

(1) $t_1^2 : t_2^2 = r_1^3 : r_2^3$

It is possible to rewrite (1) as (2).

$t_1^2 / r_1 : t_2^2 / r_2 = r_1^2 : r_2^2$

(2) $1 / r_1^2 : 1 / r_2^2 = r_1 / t_1^2 : r_2 / t_2^2$

Taking for simplicity the accelerations for circular motion of planets one gets (3).

$a = v^2 / r$

$v = 2\pi r / t$

$a = 4\pi^2 r / t^2$

(3) $r_1 / t_1^2 : r_2 / t_2^2 = a_1 : a_2$

Combining (2) and (3) one gets that accelerations are inversely proportional to the square of distances (4).

(4) $1 / r_1^2 : 1 / r_2^2 = a_1 : a_2$

In such a way the Kepler's law (2) is actually the Newton's law without masses: accelerations are inversely proportional to the square of distances (4). Using the second Newton's law one gets the Newton's law with masses (5). The forces involved in motion of planets are proportional to the masses of planets and inversely proportional to the square of the distances.

$f = m\ a$

(5) $m_1 / r_1^2 : m_2 / r_2^2 = f_1 : f_2$

The expression (5) does not mean that any masses attract each other. It means that the planets are moving in compliance with the Kepler's law (2). If an object falls on a planet it moves in compliance with the motions of the planets, but it does not mean that an object attracts a planet. There is neither such evidence nor evidence that all objects on some planet attract each other. The planets of the Solar system do not exist by themselves they exist only together in combination with other planets of the Solar system. As well as the combinations of two pairs of masses in Cavendish experiment can cause the movement of masses, likewise the combinations of the planets of the Solar system can cause the motion of the planets.